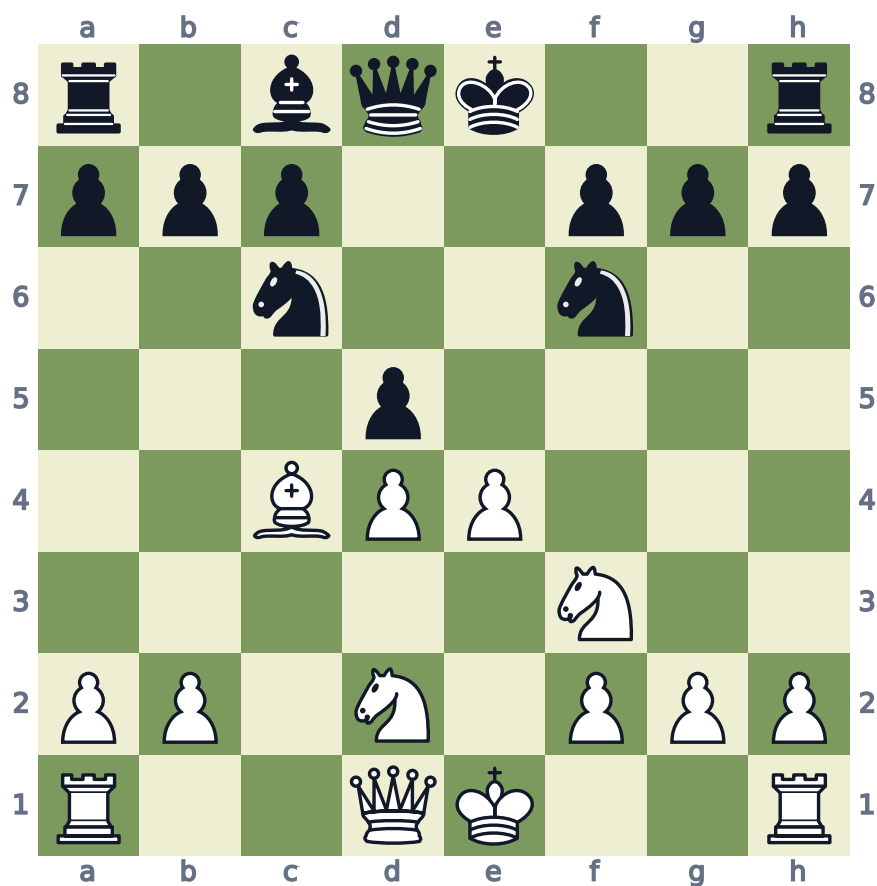


Opening Traps and Their Refutations

Tempting mistakes, tactical punishment, and safe responses



Learn traps as failures of development, geometry, and move order - including how to spot them, refuse them, and punish unsound attempts without memorizing tricks blindly.

20 practice units | separated solutions | scoring | review plan

ORIENTATION

How to get real improvement from this course

PURPOSE

Learn traps as failures of development, geometry, and move order - including how to spot them, refuse them, and punish unsound attempts without memorizing tricks blindly.

TRAINING RULES

- Never play the opponent's expected capture automatically; search for checks and attacks on the queen first.
- Explain which opening principle the tempting move violates.
- Learn the safe response and the resulting plan, not only the tactical punishment.
- Test every trap against the opponent's least cooperative defense.

COURSE SIZE

This PDF contains 20 practice units. Problems appear before their solutions whenever practical. Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days.

SCORING

What a complete answer contains

RECOGNITION

Name the tactical or strategic feature without assuming that the familiar pattern works.

CANDIDATES

List serious forcing and improving choices before analyzing deeply.

BEST RESISTANCE

Calculate the opponent's least cooperative legal response.

ENDPOINT

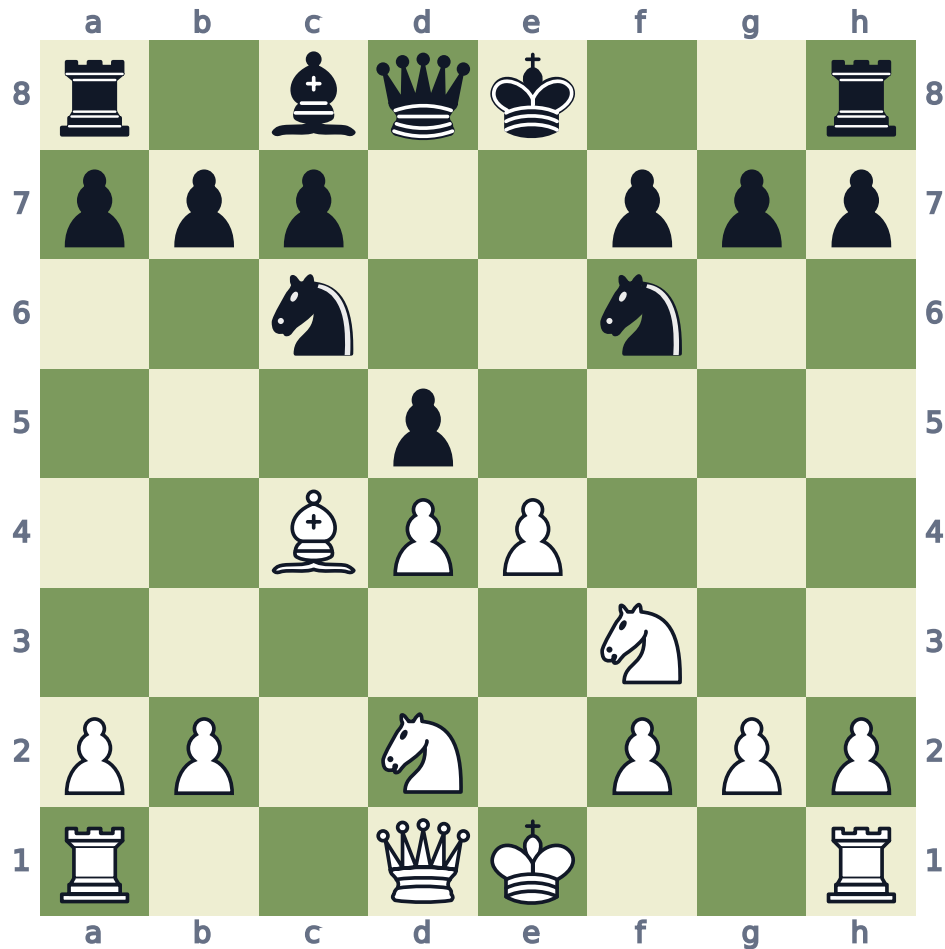
Stop only after forcing play settles, then evaluate material, kings, activity, and structure.

TRANSFER

State the visible cue that should make you remember this position during a game.

PROBLEM 01 OF 20

Italian Game: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Bb3. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

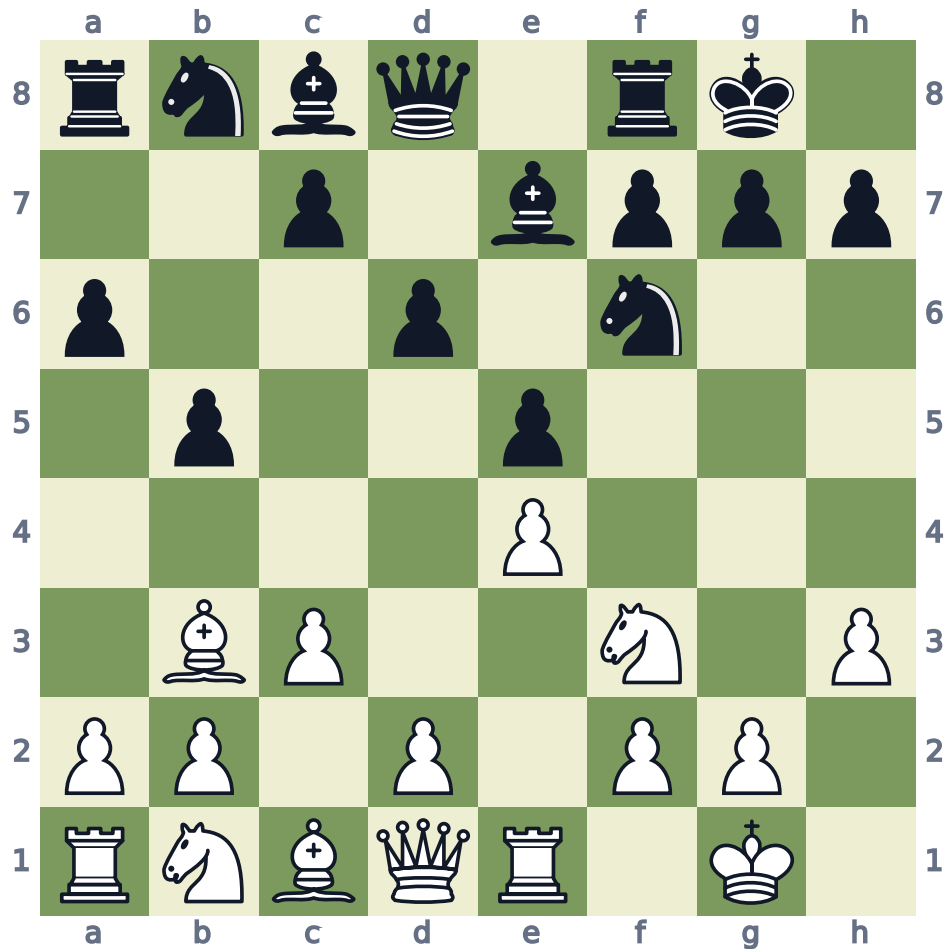
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 02 OF 20

Ruy Lopez: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is a3. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

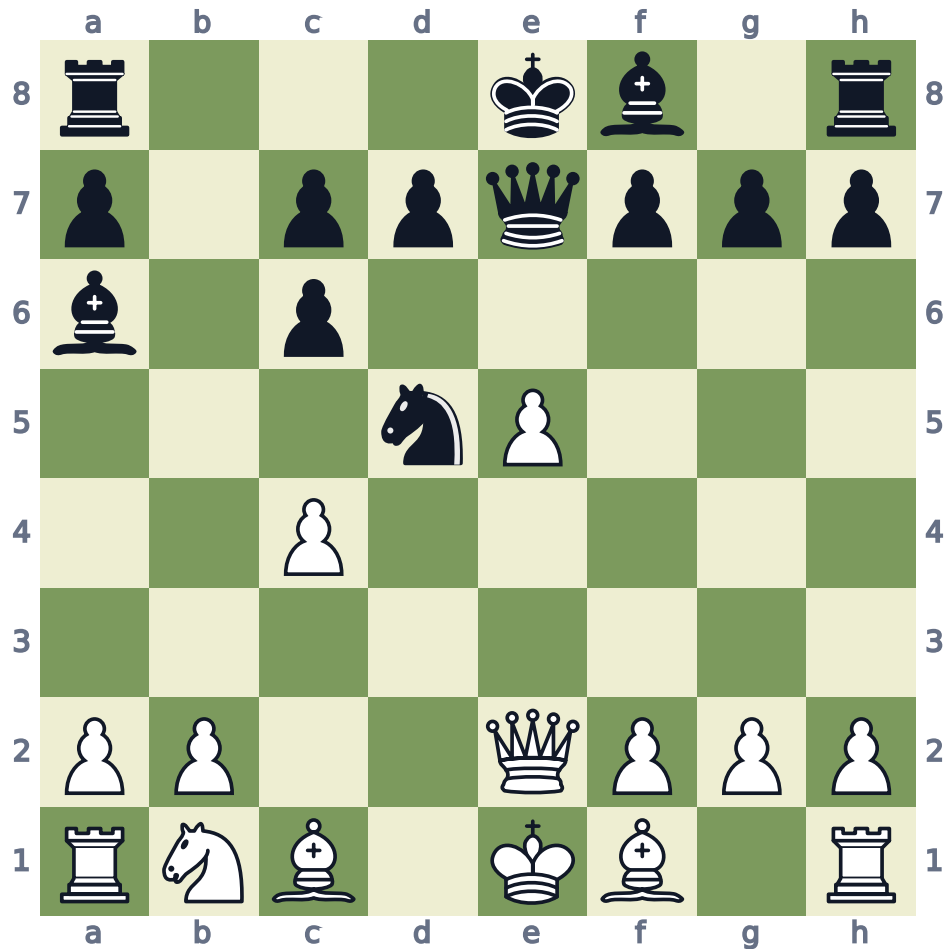
Opening trap and refutation

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Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 03 OF 20

Scotch Game: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Bd2. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

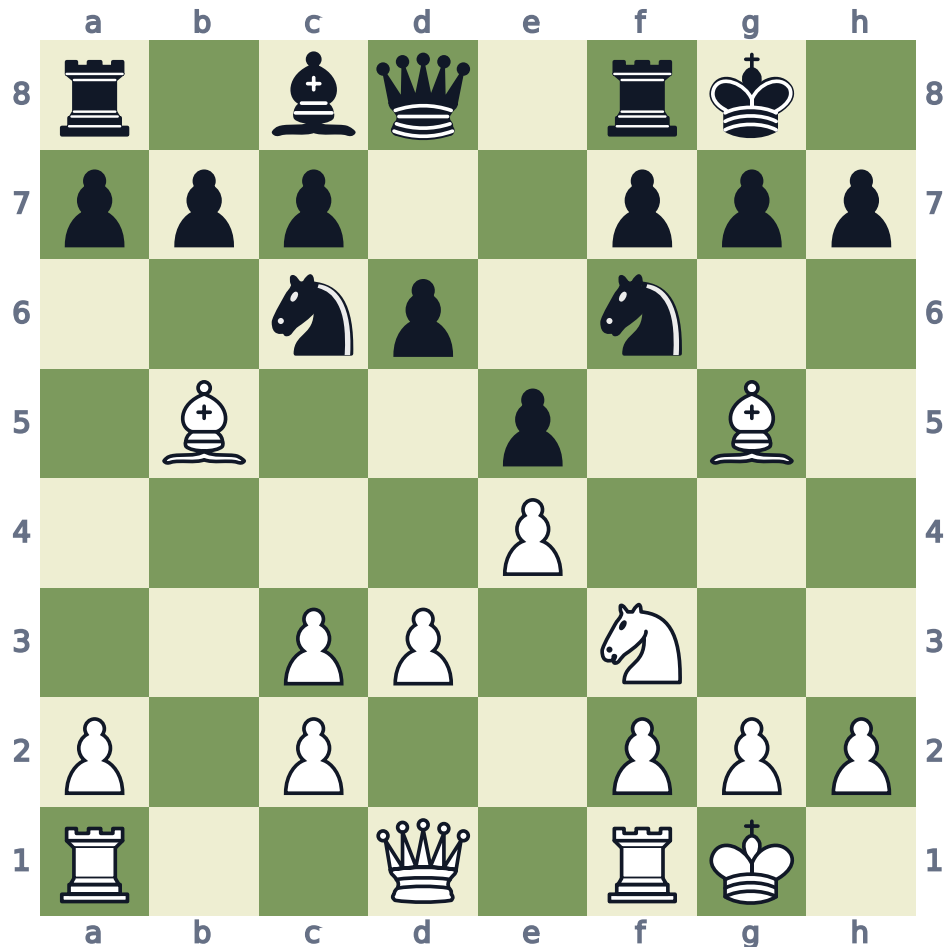
Opening trap and refutation

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Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 04 OF 20

Four Knights Game: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Kh8. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

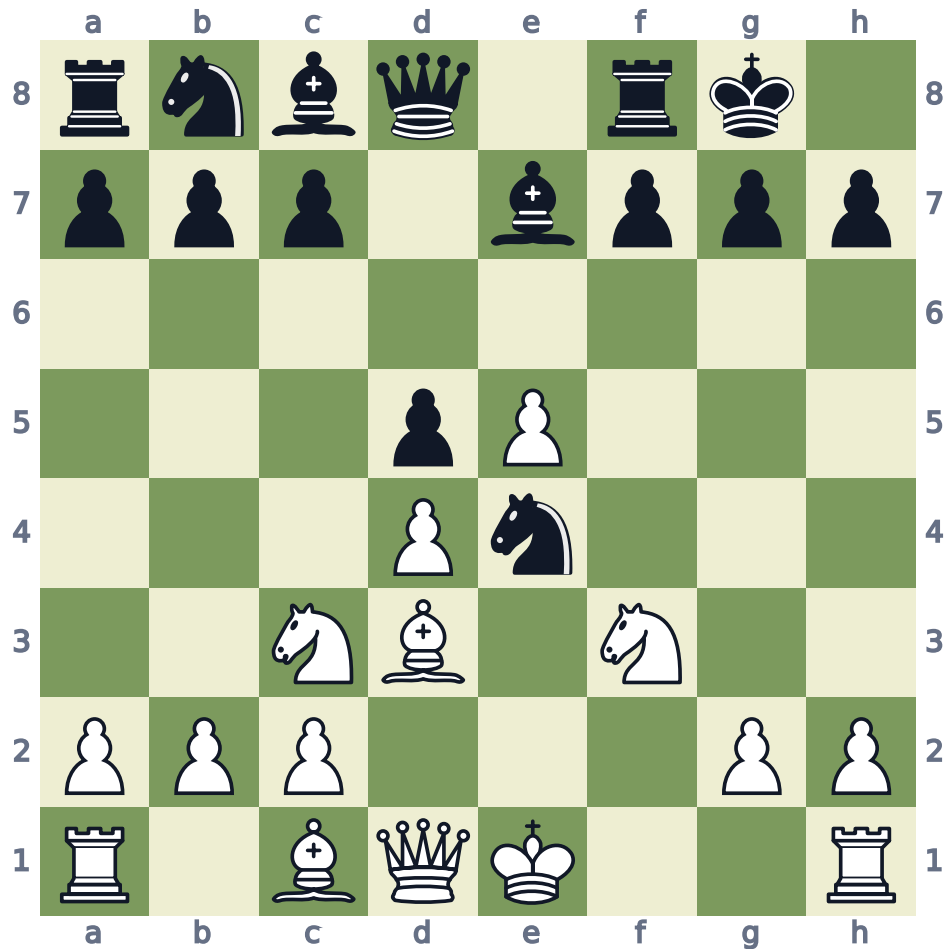
Opening trap and refutation

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Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 05 OF 20

Vienna Game: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Bh4+. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

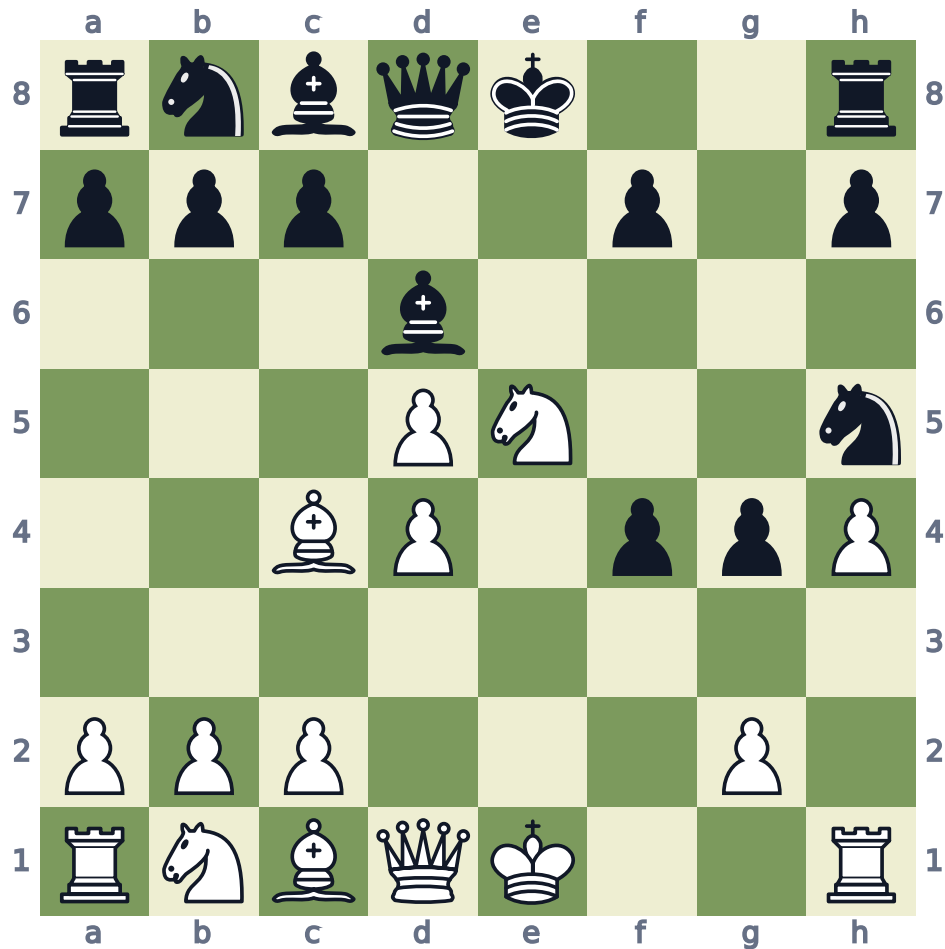
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 06 OF 20

King's Gambit: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Be2. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

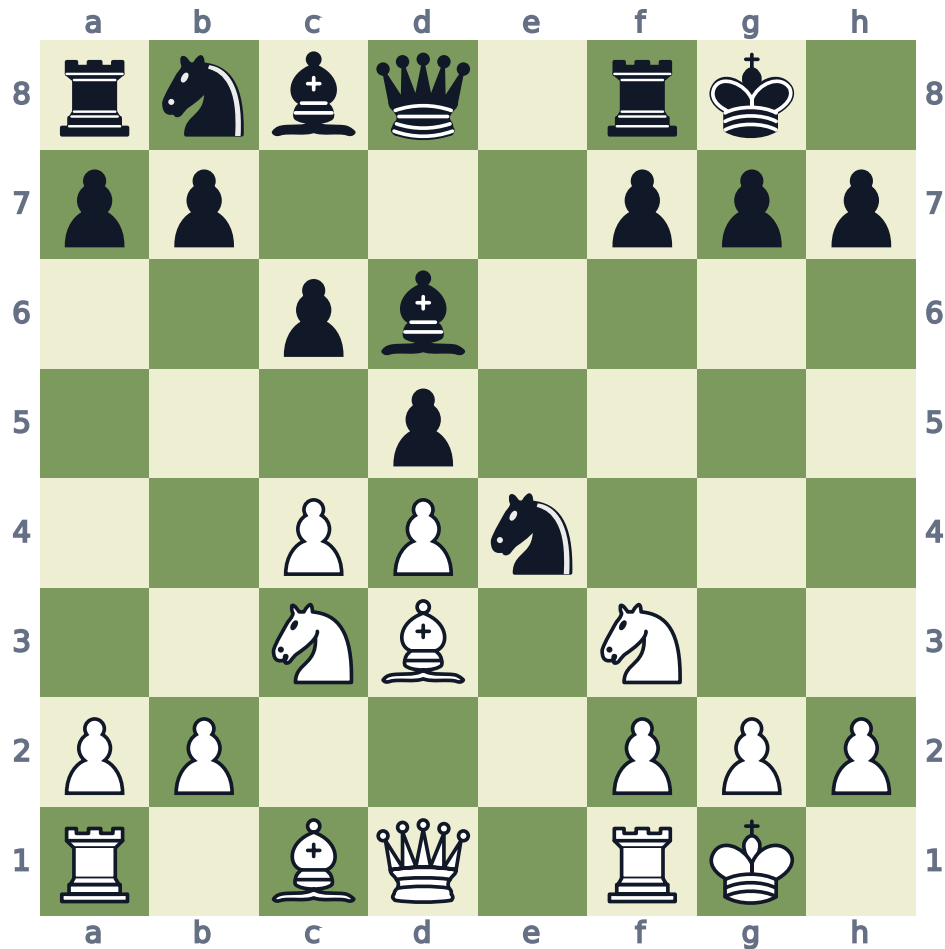
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 07 OF 20

Petrov Defense: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Bg4. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

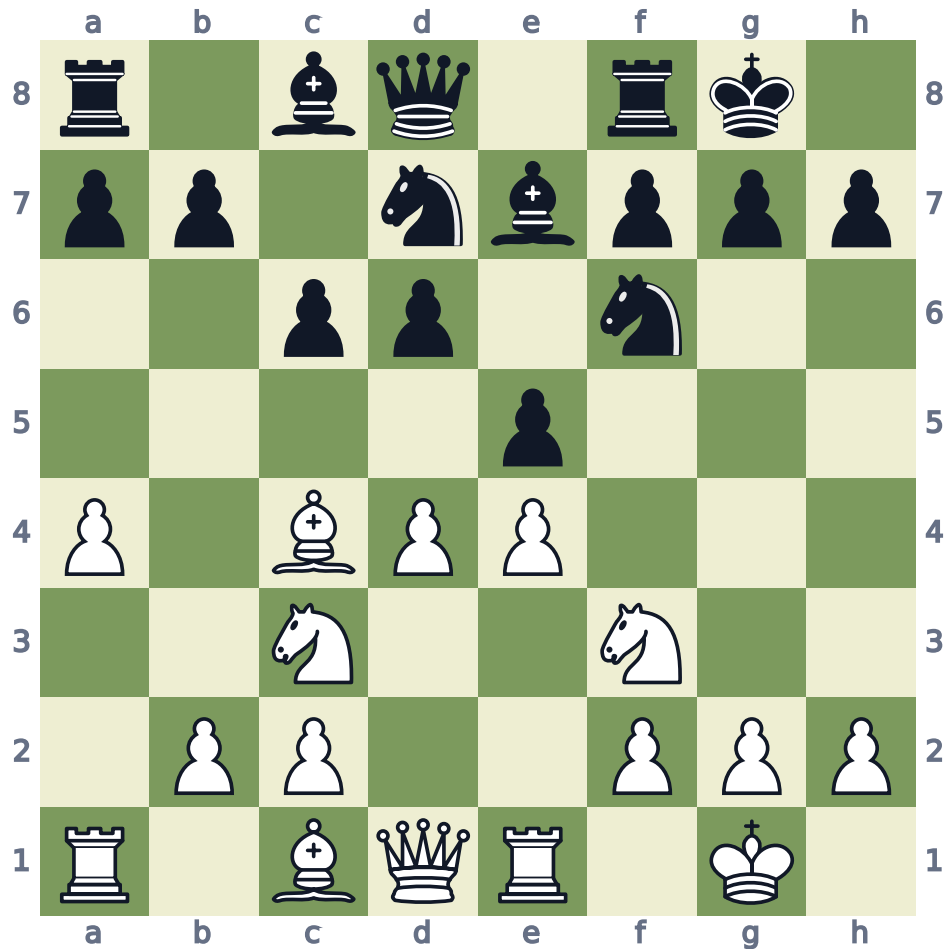
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 08 OF 20

Philidor Defense: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is h6. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

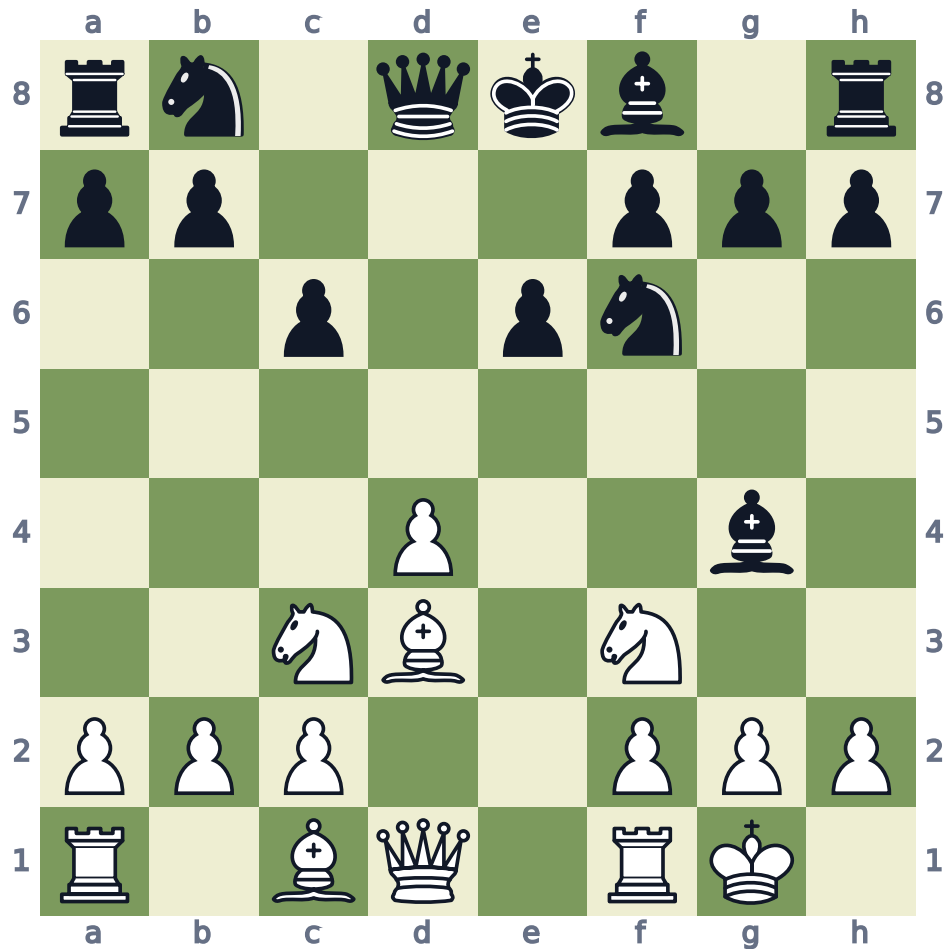
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 09 OF 20

Scandinavian Defense: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Bd2. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 10 OF 20

French Defense: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Bb4. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

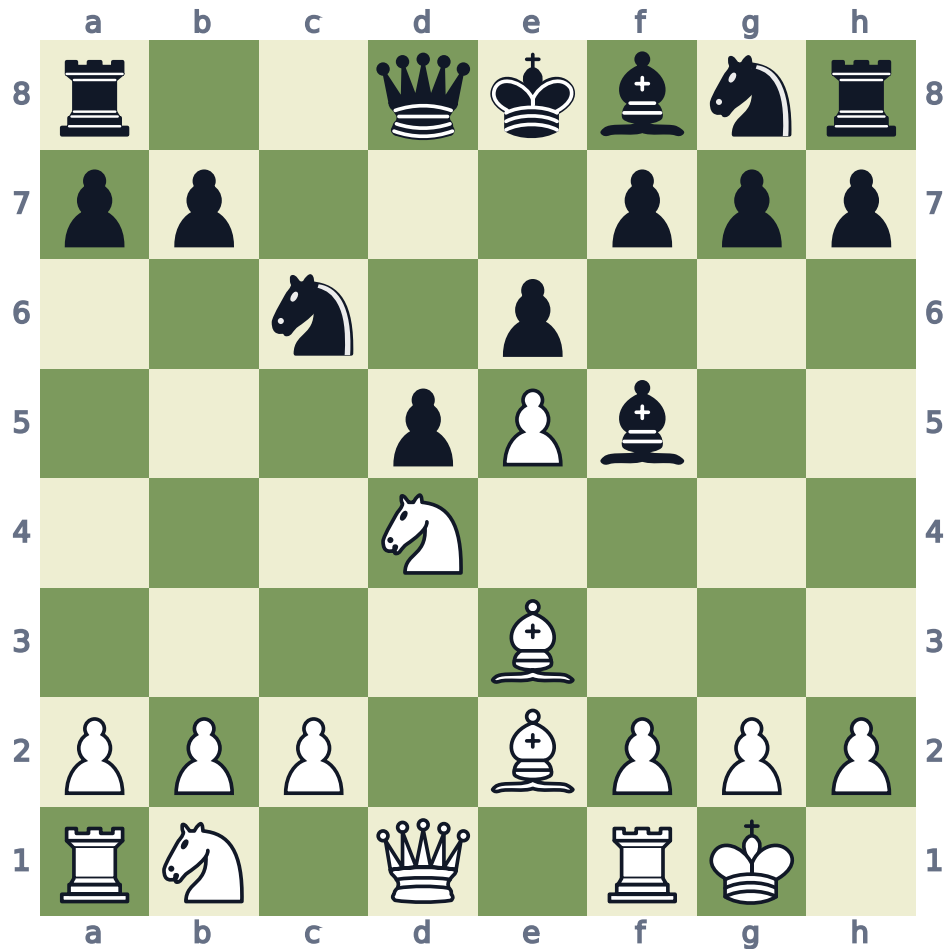
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 11 OF 20

Caro-Kann Defense: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Rc8. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

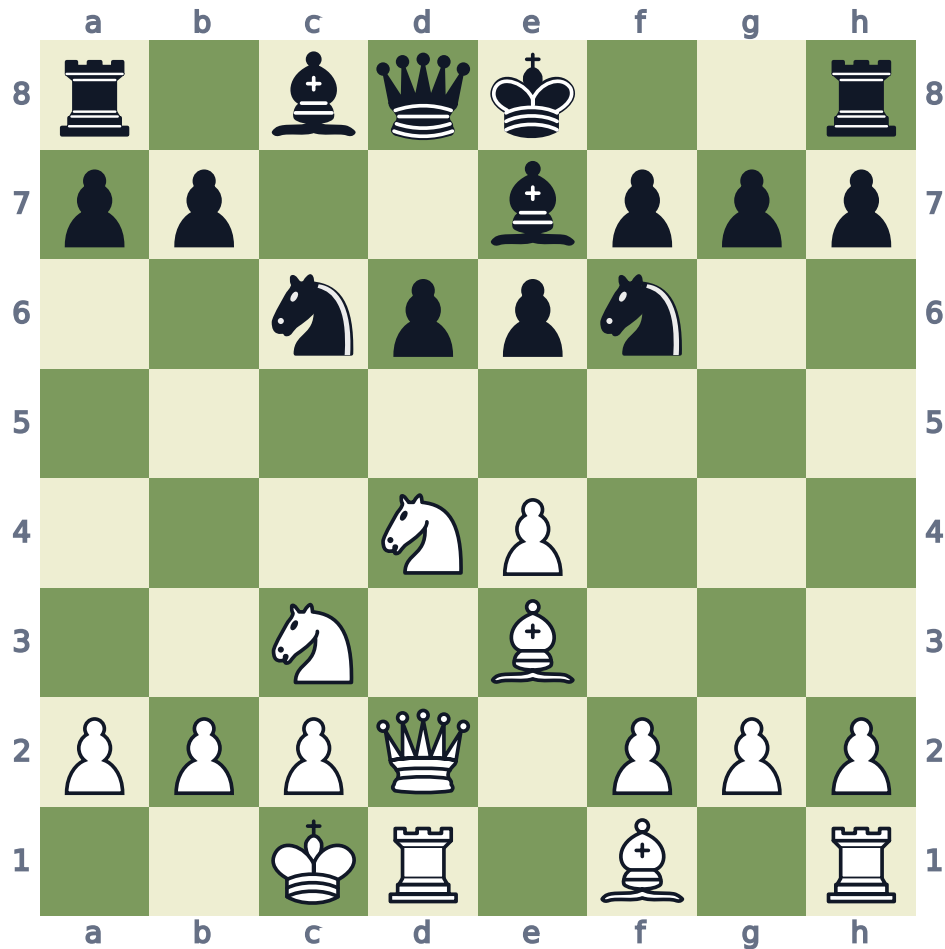
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 12 OF 20

Open Sicilian: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Rb8. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

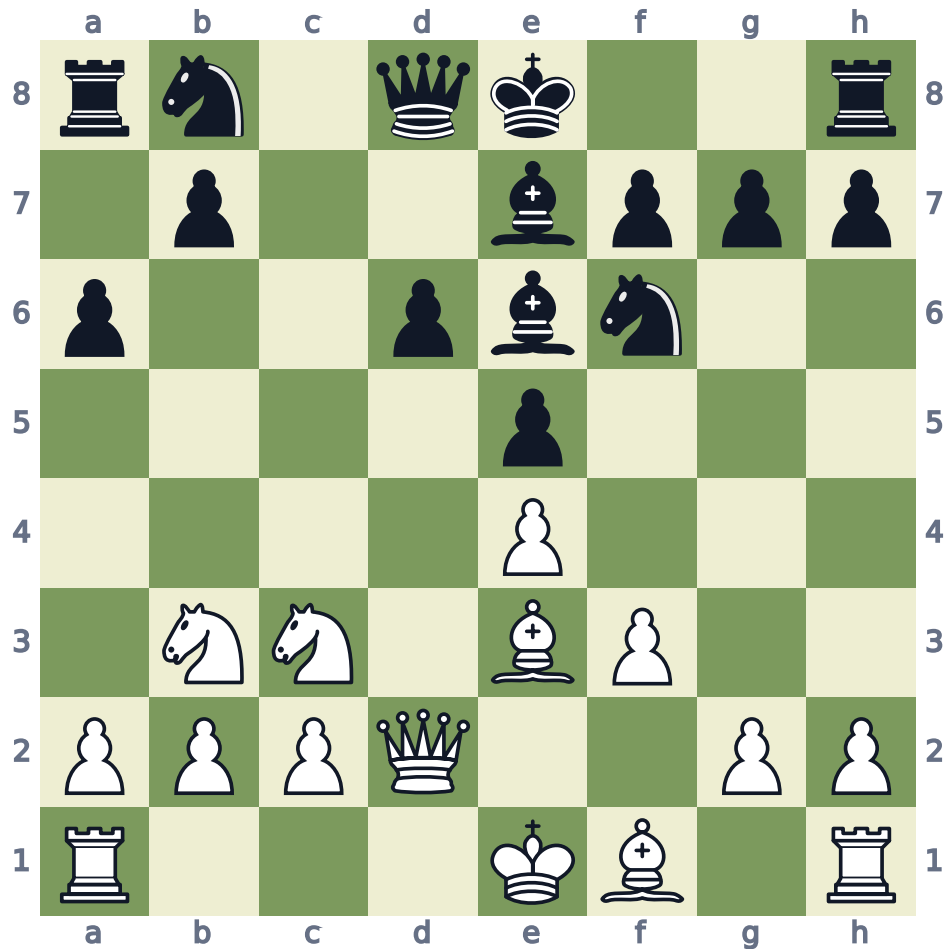
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 13 OF 20

Sicilian Najdorf: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is d5. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

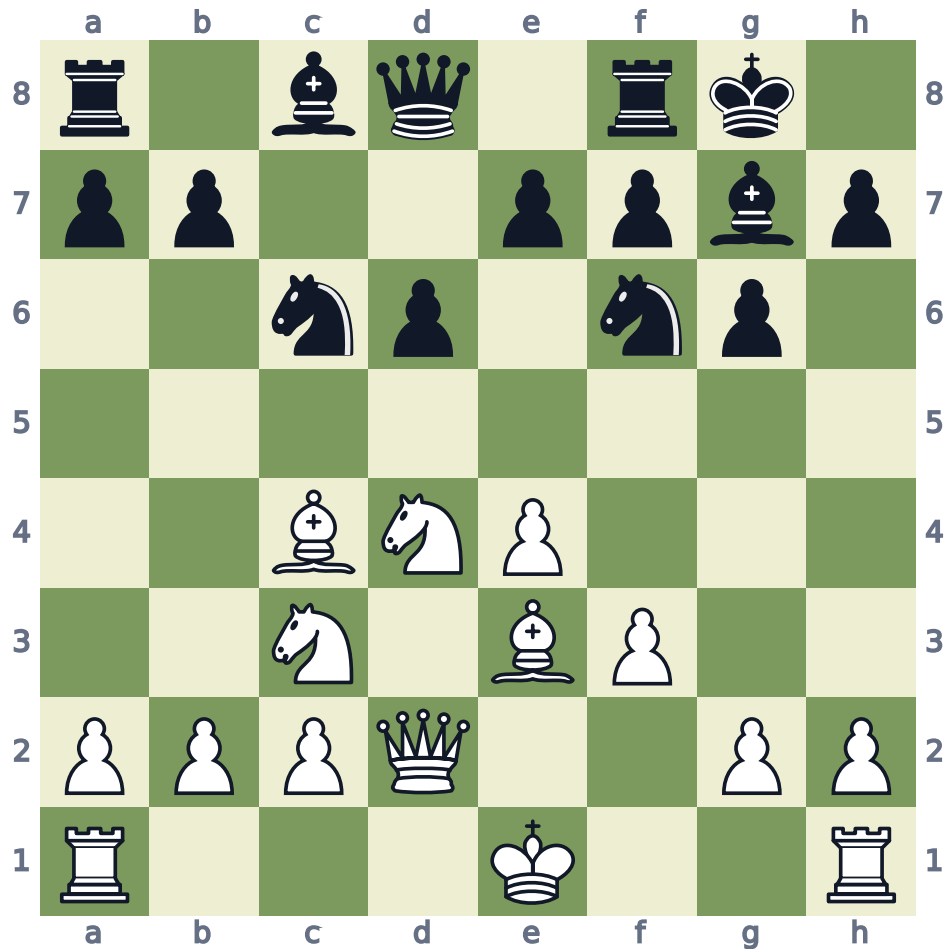
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 14 OF 20

Sicilian Dragon: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is a6. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

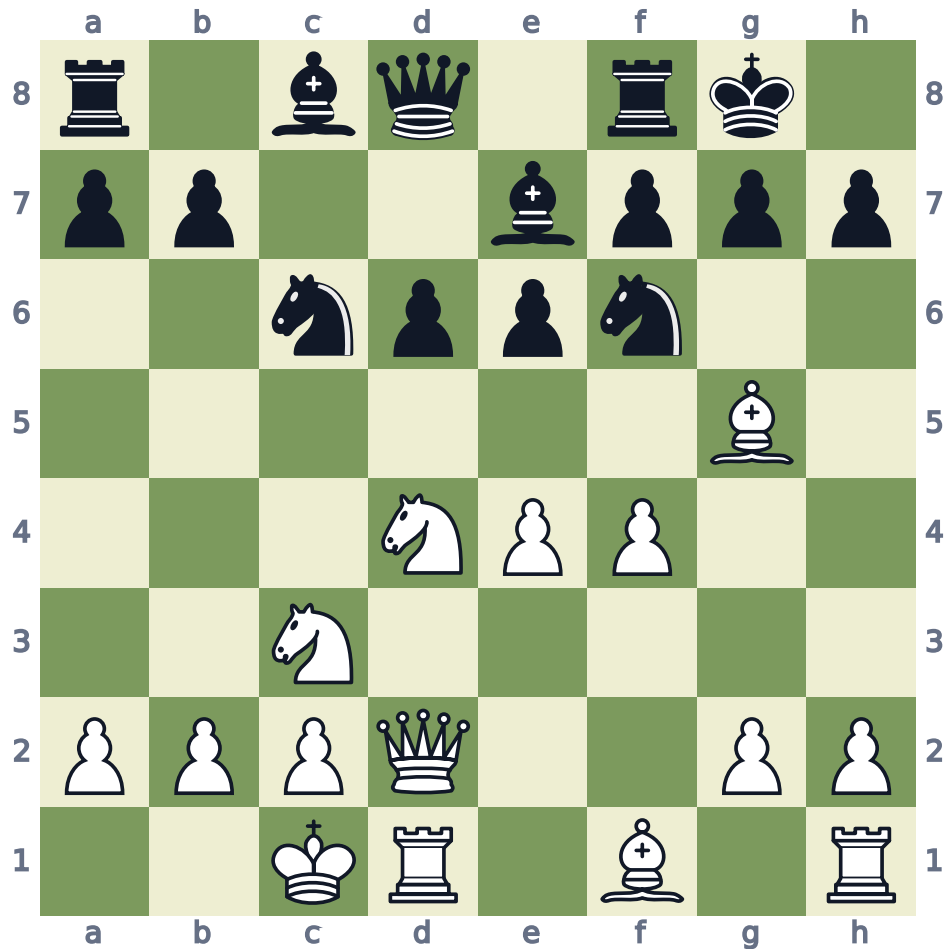
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 15 OF 20

Classical Sicilian: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is a6. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

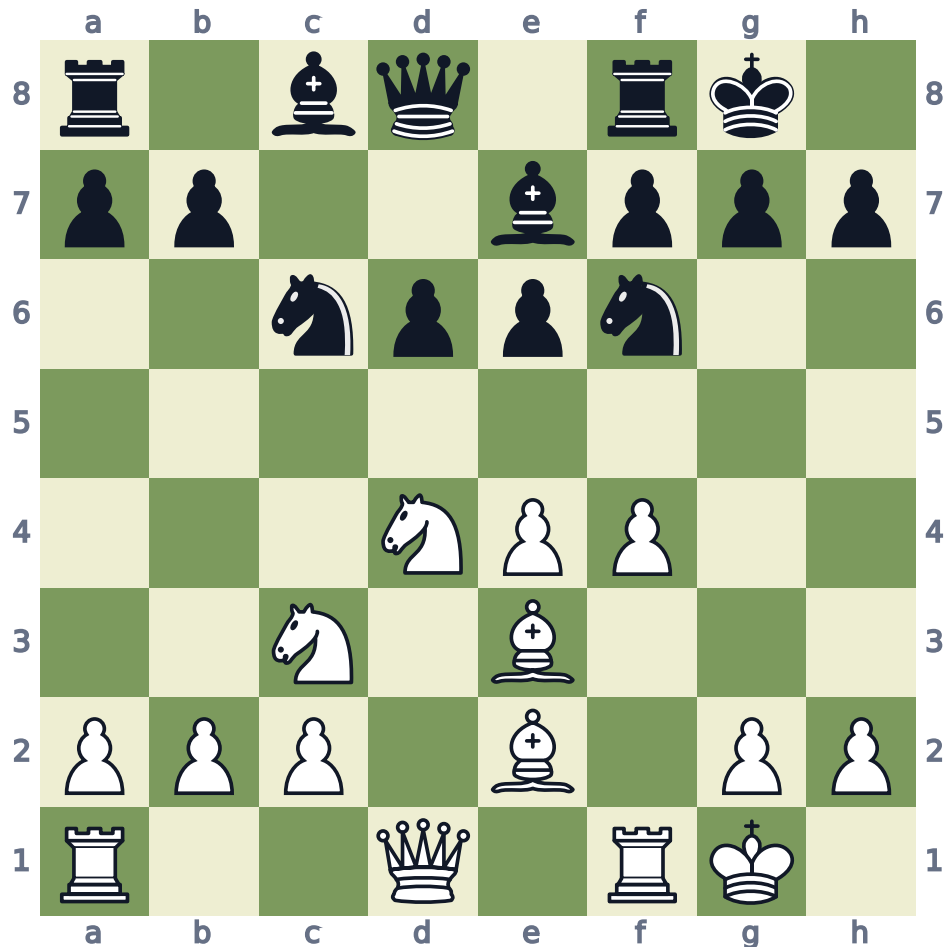
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 16 OF 20

Sicilian Scheveningen: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Re8. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

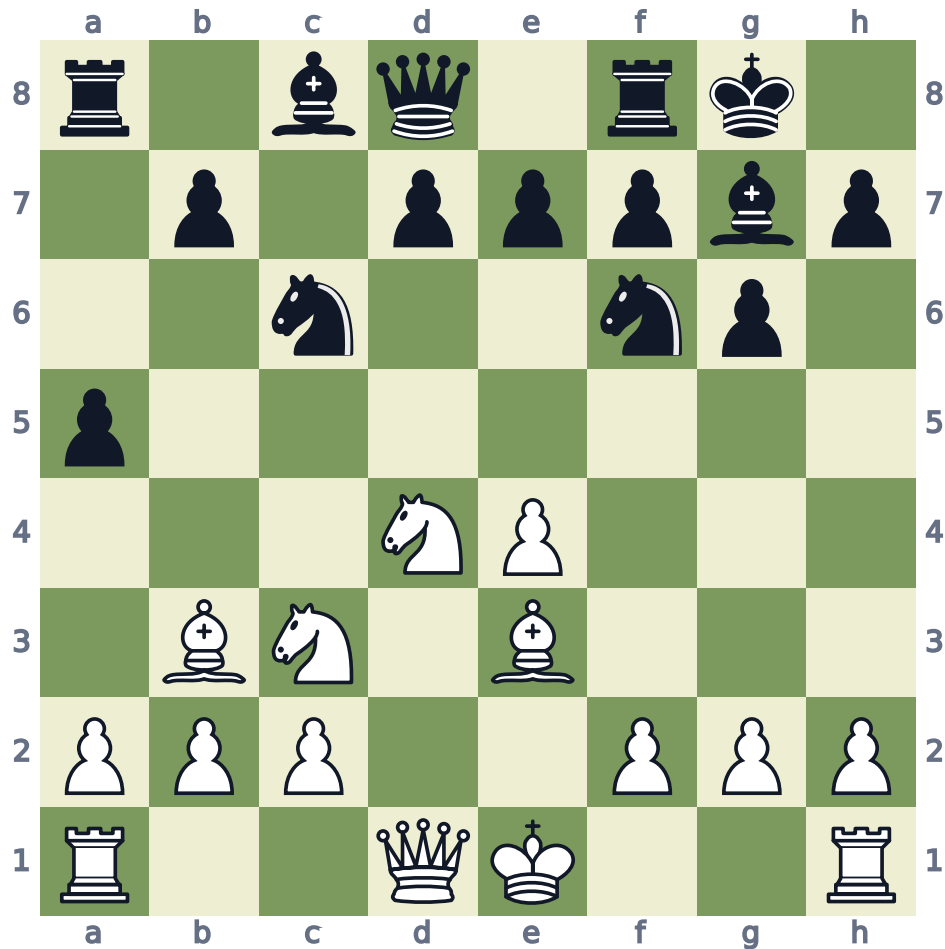
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 17 OF 20

Accelerated Dragon: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Qf3. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

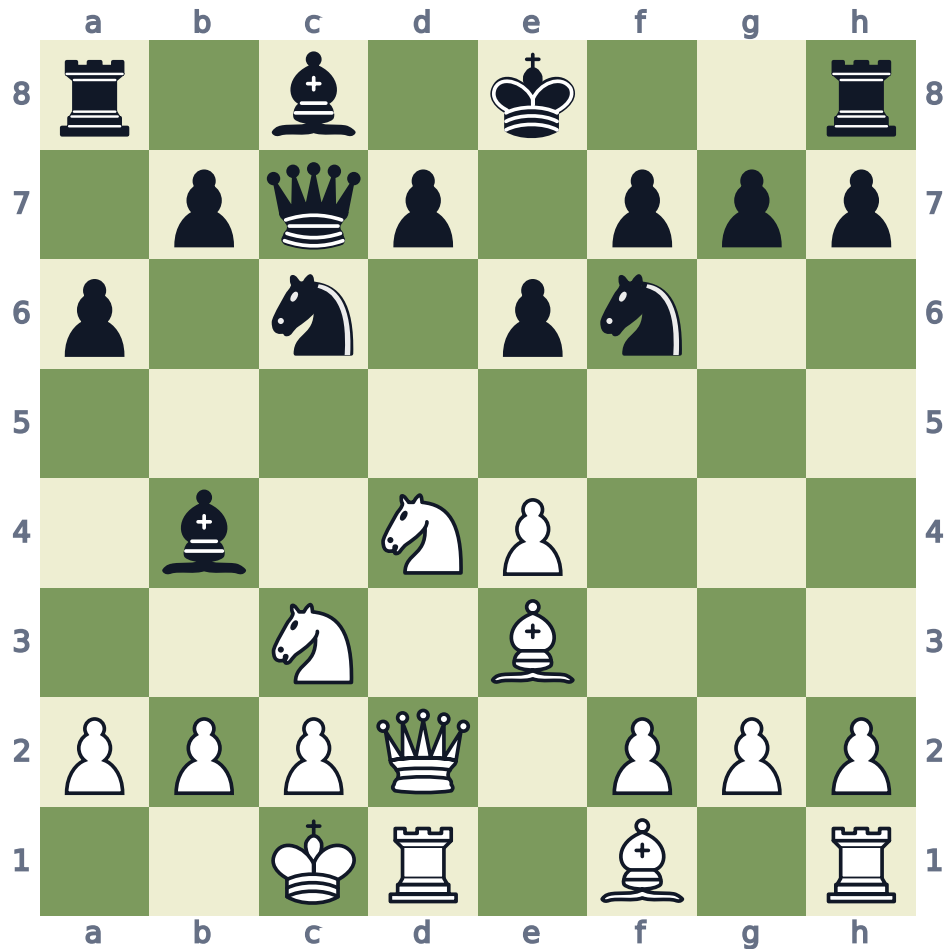
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 18 OF 20

Sicilian Taimanov: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Be2. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

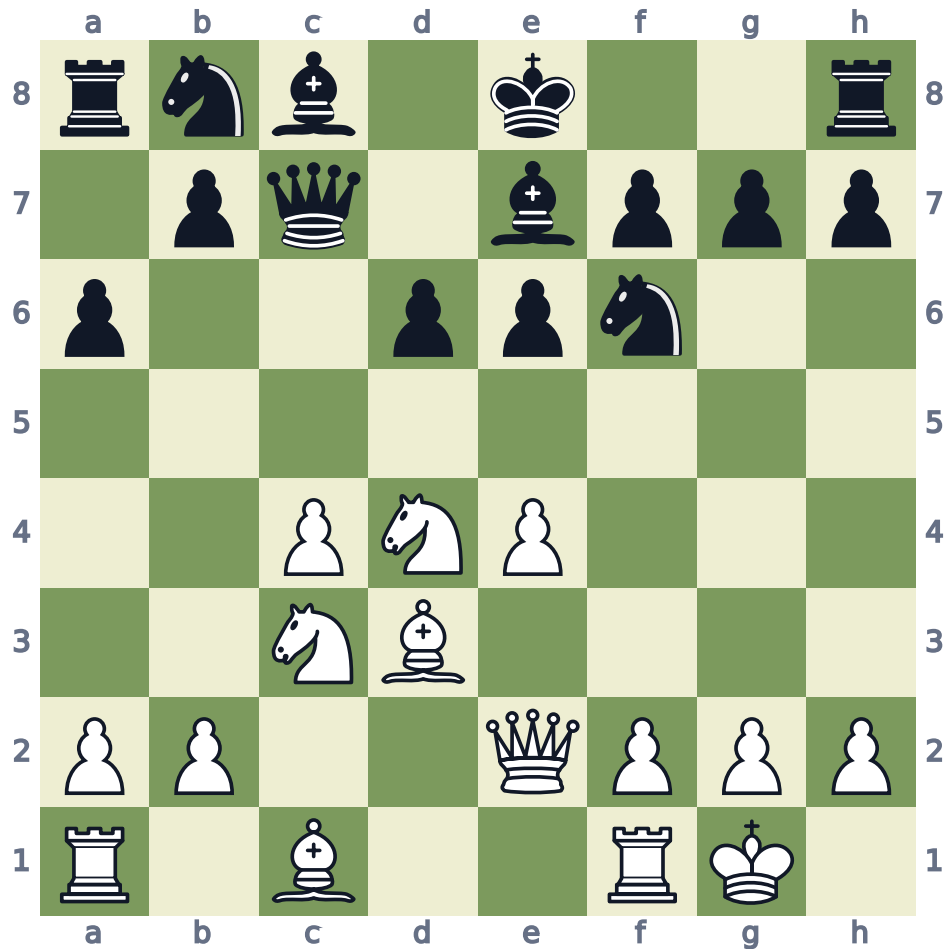
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 19 OF 20

Sicilian Kan: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is h6. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

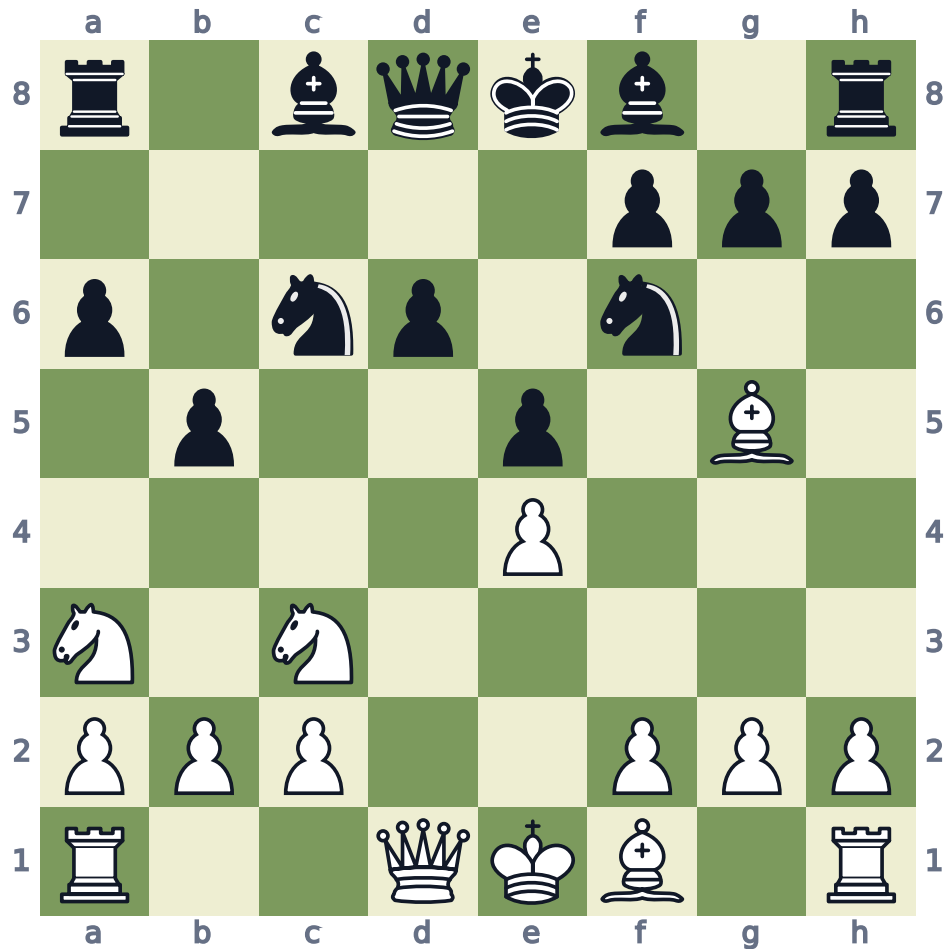
Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 20 OF 20

Sicilian Sveshnikov: refuse the tempting move



YOUR TASK

The tempting candidate is Ncb1. Before playing it, find the opponent's most forcing punishment. Then choose a safer continuation.

DIFFICULTY

Opening trap and refutation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

ANSWER SECTION

Solutions begin on the next page

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not browse the solution pages casually. Return to each problem, reconstruct the position, and compare the entire decision process. If your move matches but your line omits the best defense, score it as incomplete.

ERROR LABELS

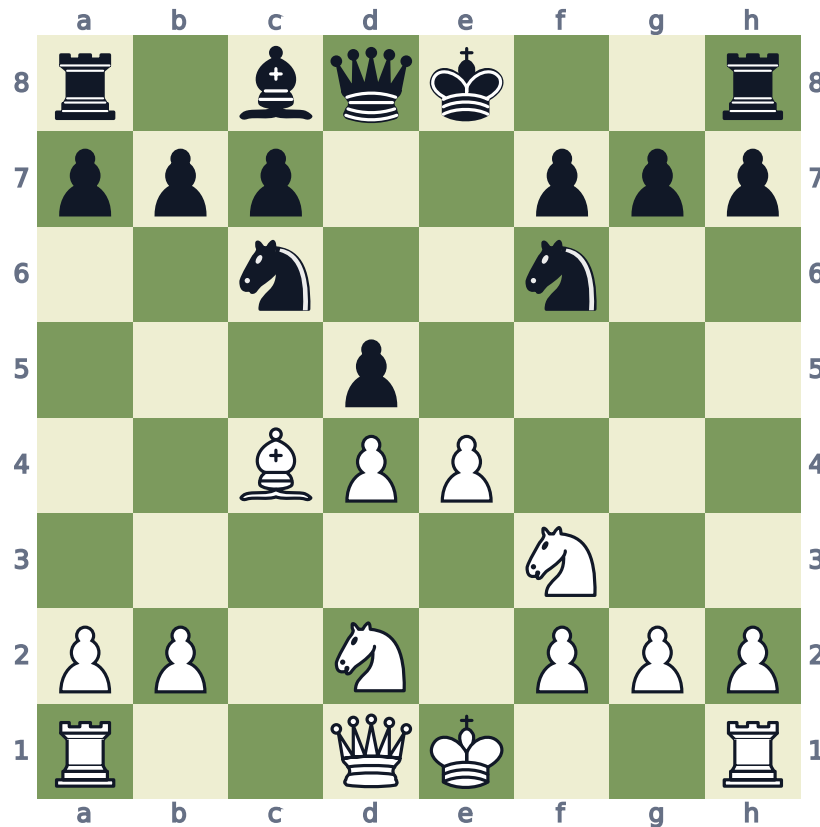
R = recognition error | C = candidate error | V = visualization error | D = missed defense | E = endpoint evaluation error | T = time-management error

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce one replacement question. Example: 'Before I calculate my attack, what countercheck does the opponent have?' Use that question in the next five slow games.

SOLUTION 01 OF 20

Italian Game: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Bb3. Punishment: 1. dxe4 Ne5 2. O-O Nxc6 3. bxc6 O-O 4. Qxd4 Nc4 5. Qc5 Qc1.
 Safer engine line: 1. exd5 Nxd5 2. Qb3 O-O 3. Bxd5 Na5 4. Qb5 c6 5. Bxc6 Nxc6.

WHY IT WORKS

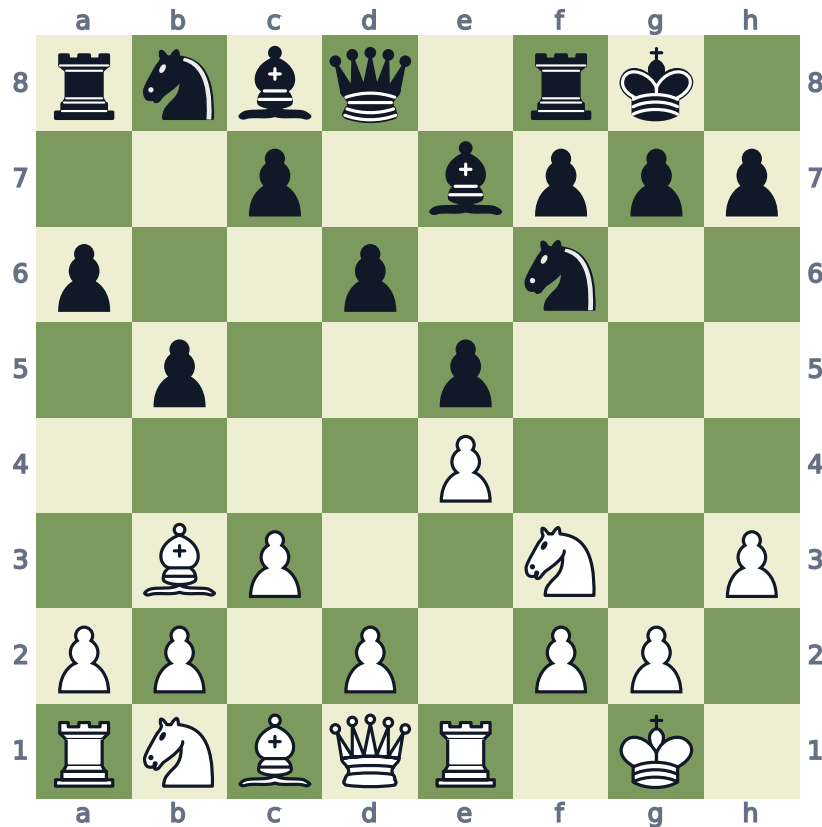
Opening identity: Fast development and a direct contest for d4 and f7. Common human mistake: Attacking f7 repeatedly while the king remains in the center. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +1.09 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 02 OF 20

Ruy Lopez: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: a3. Punishment: 1. Bb7 Bc2 2. Re8 d4 3. Nbd7 Nbd2 4. Bf8 b4 5. h6 Bb2. Safer engine line: 1. d4 Nbd7 2. a4 Bb7 3. Nbd2 c5 4. d5.

WHY IT WORKS

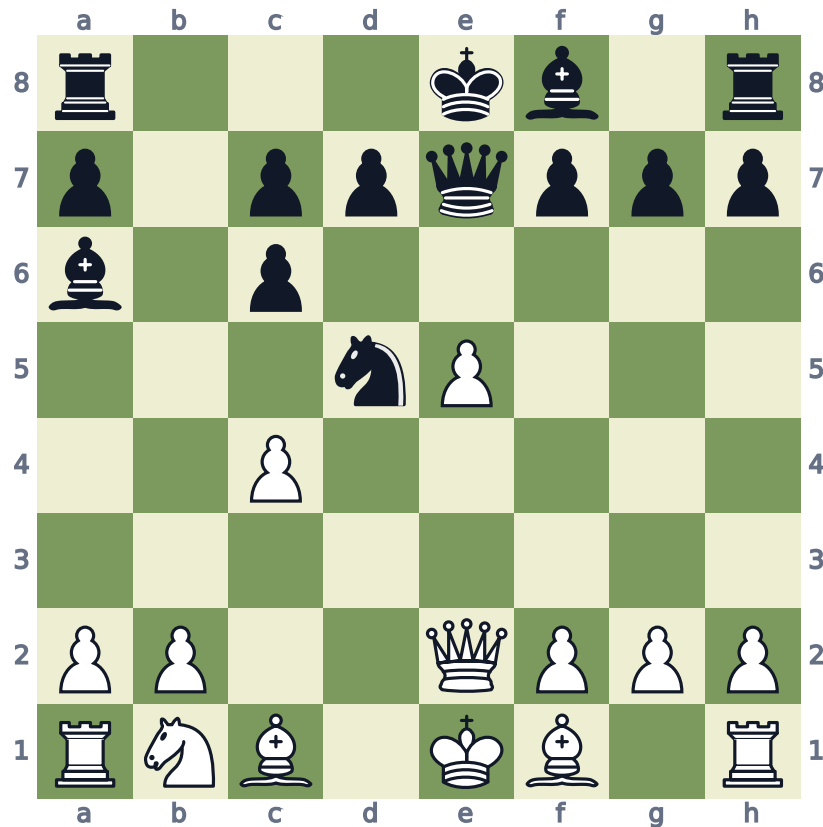
Opening identity: Long-term pressure on e5 created by pinning the c6-knight. Common human mistake: Taking c6 and e5 automatically without checking whether ...Qd4 or ...Qf6 regains the pawn. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.31 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 03 OF 20

Scotch Game: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Bd2. Punishment: 1. Nb6 b3 2. g6 Bc3 3. Bg7 g3 4. O-O Bg2 5. Rfe8 O-O. Safer engine line: 1. Nd2 f6.

WHY IT WORKS

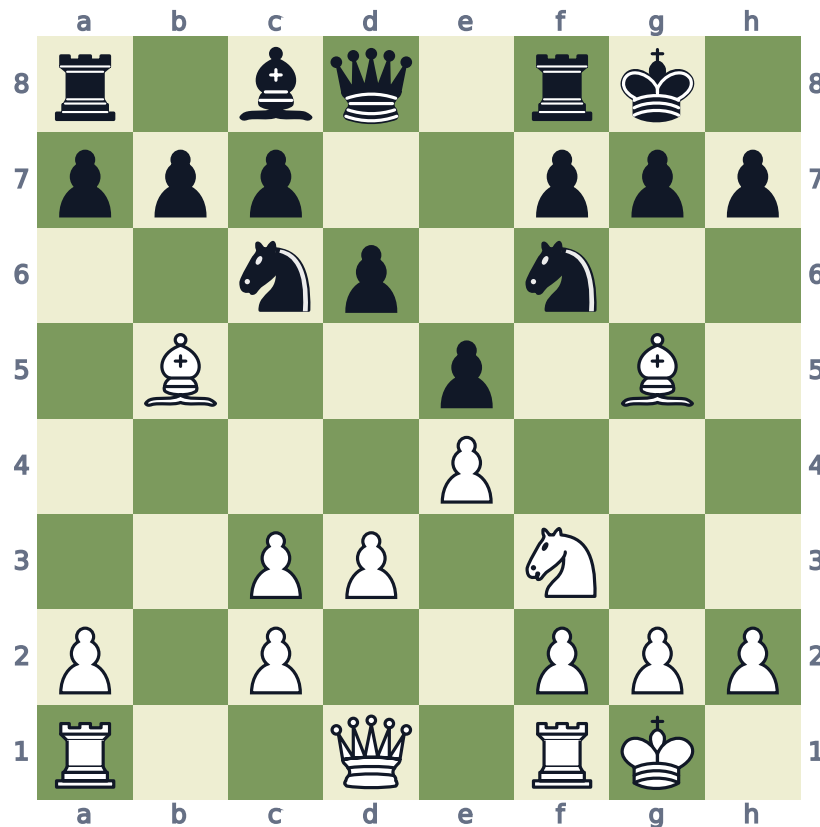
Opening identity: White opens the center immediately and asks Black's pieces concrete questions. Common human mistake: Trading in the center and then making extra queen moves while pieces remain home. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.38 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 04 OF 20

Four Knights Game: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Kh8. Punishment: 1. d4 Qe7 2. Re1 h6 3. Bh4 a6 4. Bxc6 bxc6 5. c4. Safer engine line: 1. h6 Bh4 2. a6 Ba4 3. Kh7 Bxf6 4. Qxf6 Bxc6 5. bxc6 Re1.

WHY IT WORKS

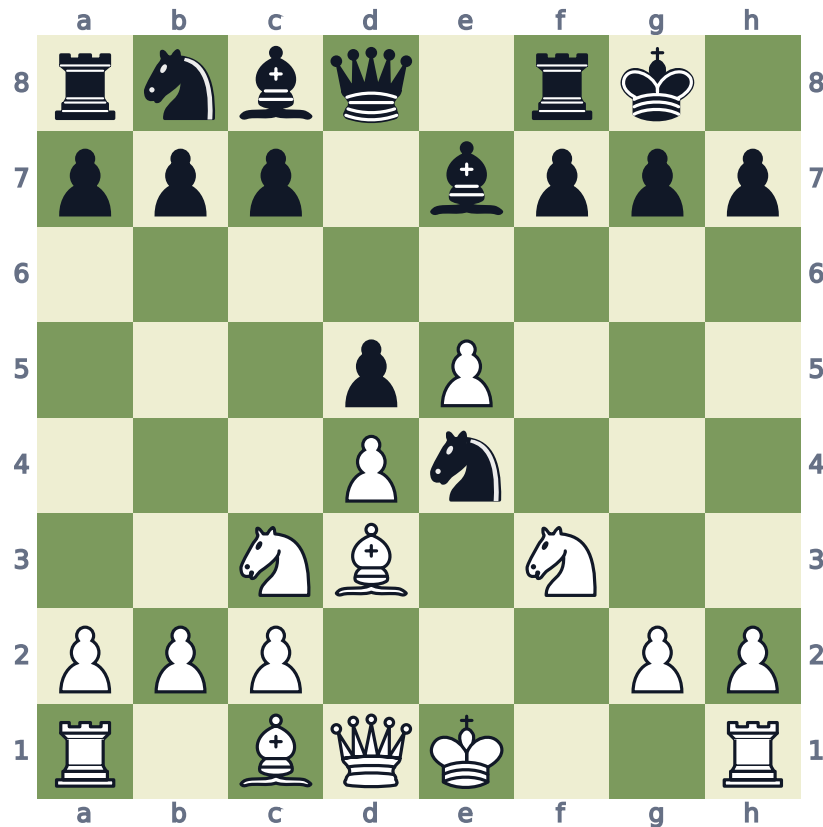
Opening identity: Natural development produces a sound, balanced center with rich middlegames. Common human mistake: Assuming symmetry means there are no tactics after one side pins first. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.50 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 05 OF 20

Vienna Game: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Bh4+. Punishment: 1. g3 Nxc3 2. bxc3 Be7 3. h4 h6. Safer engine line: 1. Nxc3 bxc3 2. c5 a4 3. f6.

WHY IT WORKS

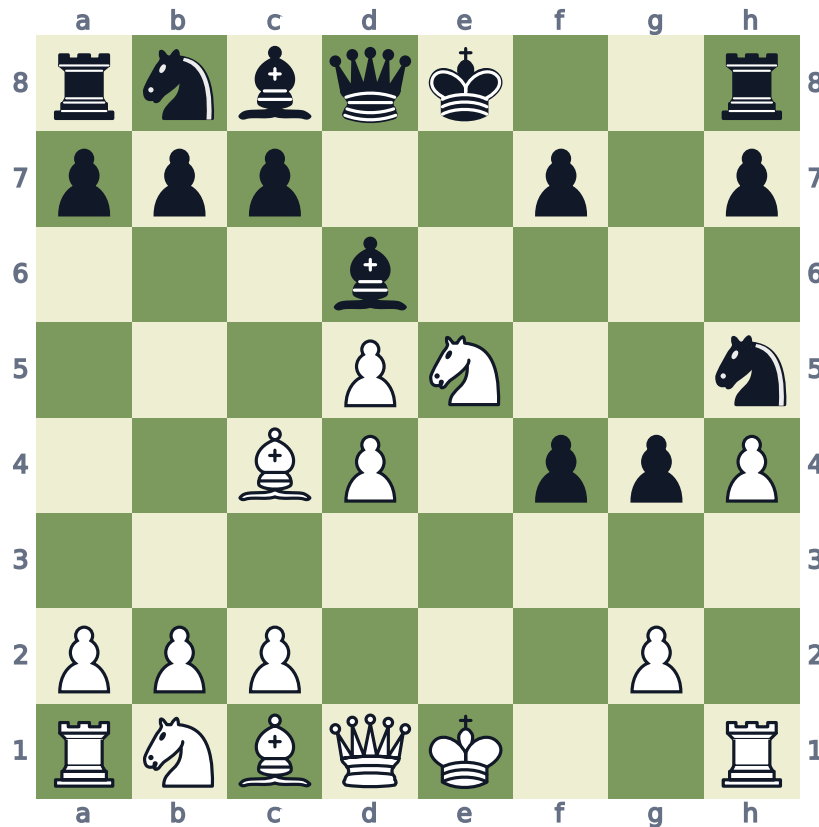
Opening identity: Flexible development with the option of a fast f-pawn attack. Common human mistake: Playing f4, f5, and g4 without developing or checking the center. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +1.30 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 06 OF 20

King's Gambit: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Be2. Punishment: 1. Ng3 Rh2 2. Qf6 Nxg4 3. Bxg4 Bxg4 4. O-O Nc3 5. Re8+ Kf2.
 Safer engine line: 1. O-O Qxh4 2. Qe1 Qxe1 3. Rxe1 O-O 4. Nc3 f6.

WHY IT WORKS

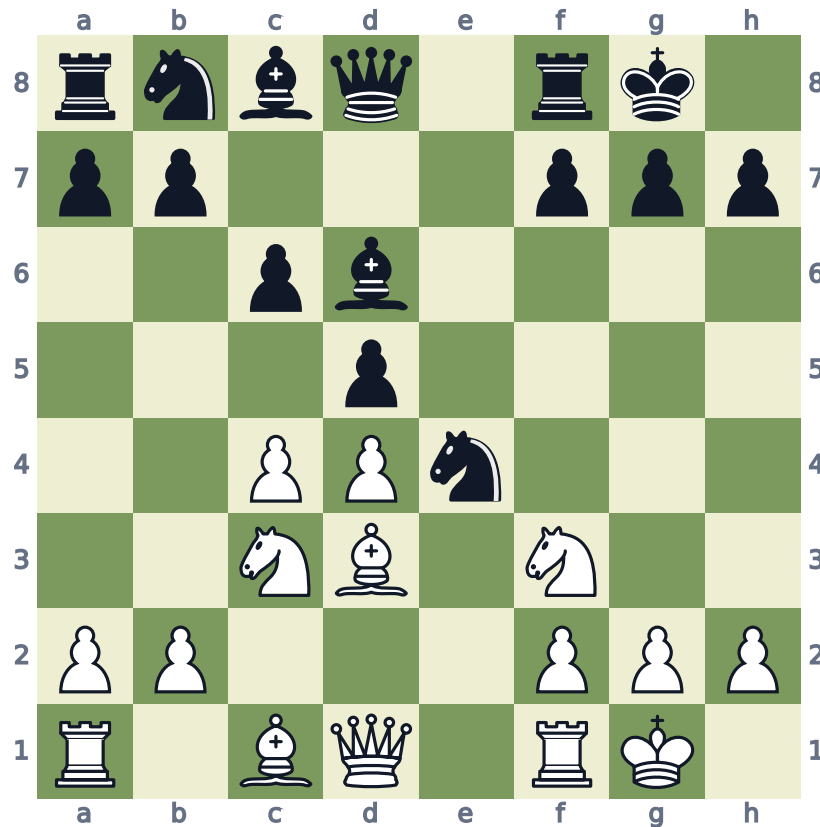
Opening identity: White offers a pawn to pull Black's e-pawn away and accelerate an attack. Common human mistake: Trying to win the f4-pawn back immediately instead of completing development. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +1.82 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 07 OF 20

Petrov Defense: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Bg4. Punishment: 1. Nxe4 dxe4 2. Bxe4 Nd7 3. Bc2 Re8 4. Qd3 Nf8 5. Bd2 Qd7.
Safer engine line: 1. Nxc3 bxc3 2. dxc4 Bxc4 3. Nd7 Re1 4. Nb6 Bb3.

WHY IT WORKS

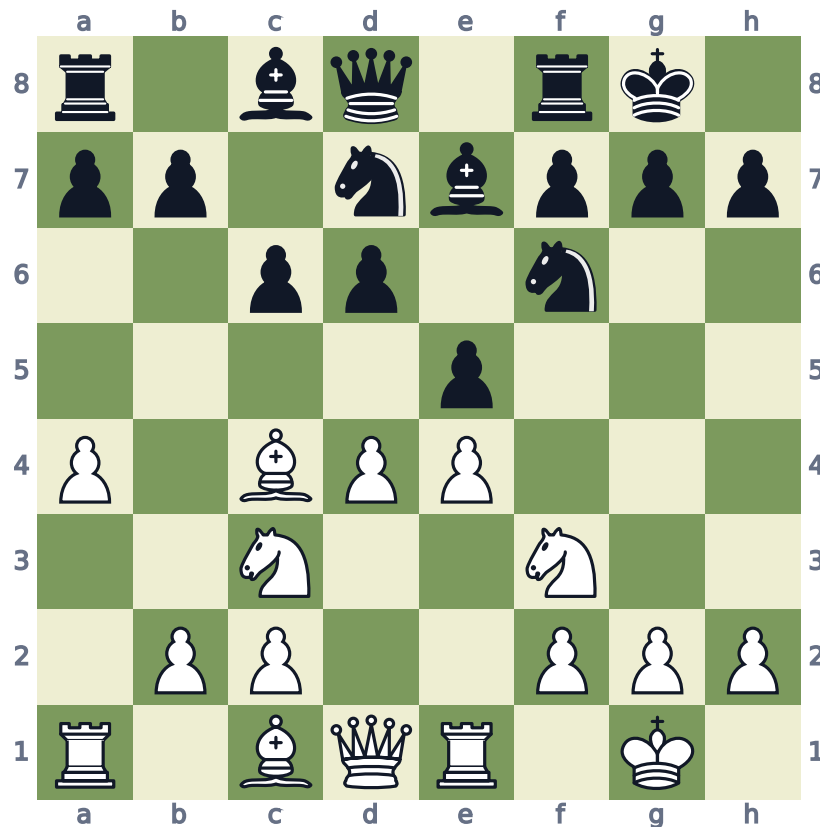
Opening identity: Black mirrors the attack on e4 and aims for active equality rather than passive defense.
Common human mistake: Copying Nxe4 before driving White's knight from e5. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +1.54 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 08 OF 20

Philidor Defense: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: h6. Punishment: 1. Be3 Re8 2. h3 exd4 3. Qxd4 Nf8 4. Rad1 Be6 5. e5. Safer engine line: 1. b6 h3 2. Bb7 Bg5 3. a6.

WHY IT WORKS

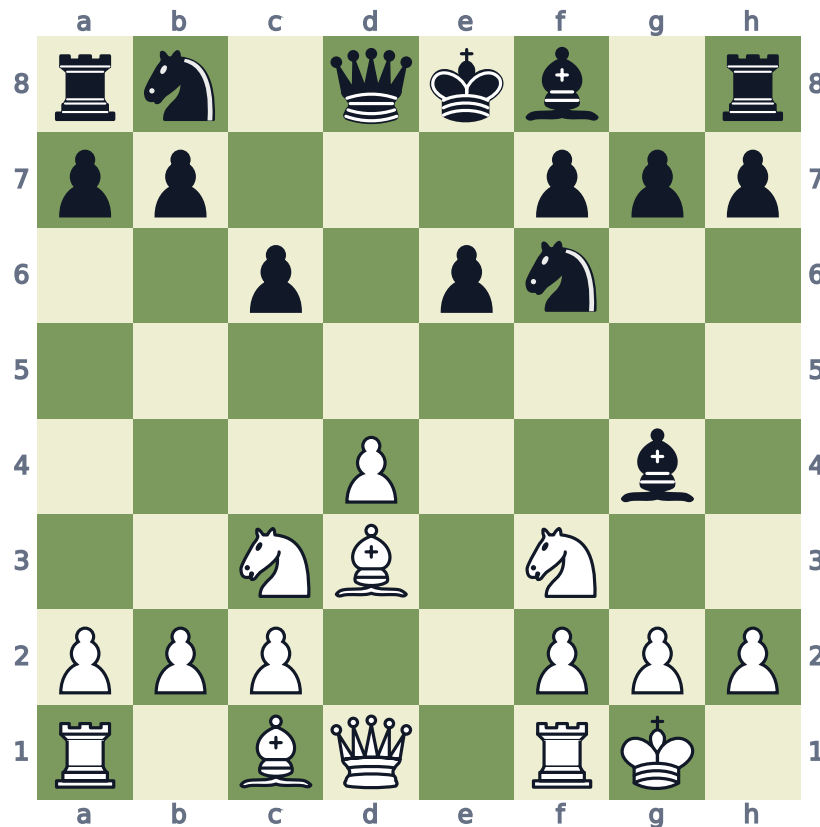
Opening identity: A compact e5-d6 chain that values solidity and controlled expansion. Common human mistake: Playing ...Nbd7, ...Be7, and ...O-O without planning a freeing break. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.56 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 09 OF 20

Scandinavian Defense: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Bd2. Punishment: 1. Bxf3 Qxf3 2. Qxd4 Bf4 3. Nbd7 Rad1 4. Qb6 Ne4 5. Nxe4 Bxe4.
Safer engine line: 1. a4 a5 2. Be3 Bh5 3. h3 Nbd7 4. g4.

WHY IT WORKS

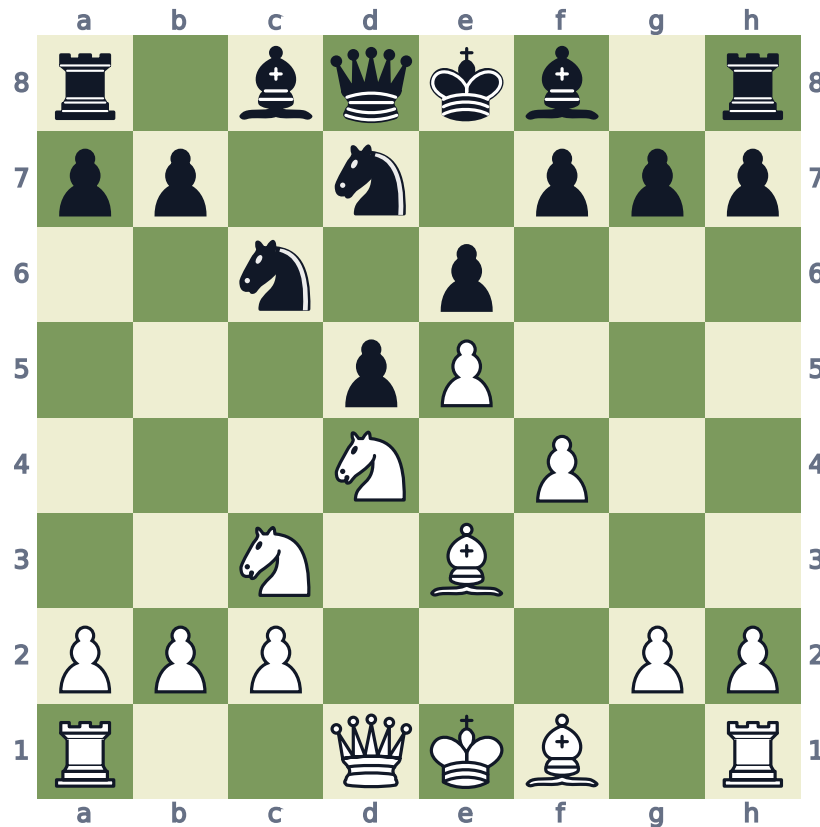
Opening identity: Black challenges e4 on move one and accepts queen tempi for a clear structure. Common human mistake: Chasing the queen with pawns that weaken White's own position. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.05 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 10 OF 20

French Defense: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Bb4. Punishment: 1. a3 Bxc3+ 2. bxc3 Nxd4 3. Bxd4 Qh4+ 4. g3 Qe7 5. Qh5 Nc5.
 Safer engine line: 1. Bc5 Qd2 2. Nxd4 Bxd4 3. O-O O-O-O 4. a6 Bxc5 5. Nxc5.

WHY IT WORKS

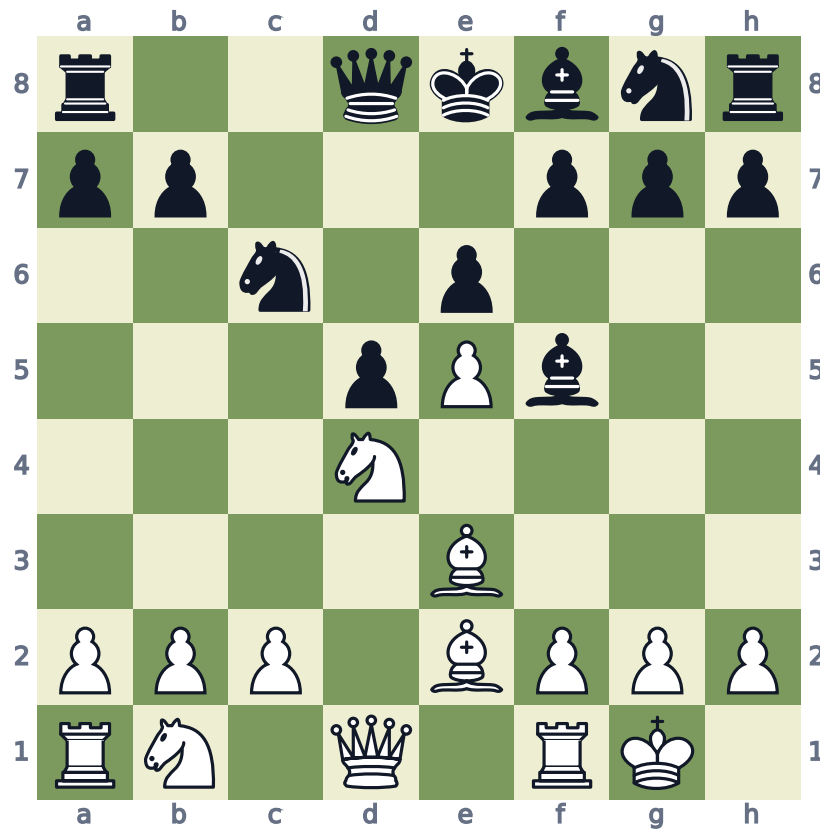
Opening identity: A locked center creates a battle between White's space and Black's pawn breaks. Common human mistake: For Black, accepting a cramped position without striking at d4; for White, attacking before development. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.75 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 11 OF 20

Caro-Kann Defense: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Rc8. Punishment: 1. Nxf5 exf5 2. c3 Nxe5 3. Re1 Bd6 4. Qxd5 Ne7 5. Qxb7 O-O.
 Safer engine line: 1. Nge7 Bb5 2. a6 Bxc6+ 3. bxc6 c4 4. dxc4.

WHY IT WORKS

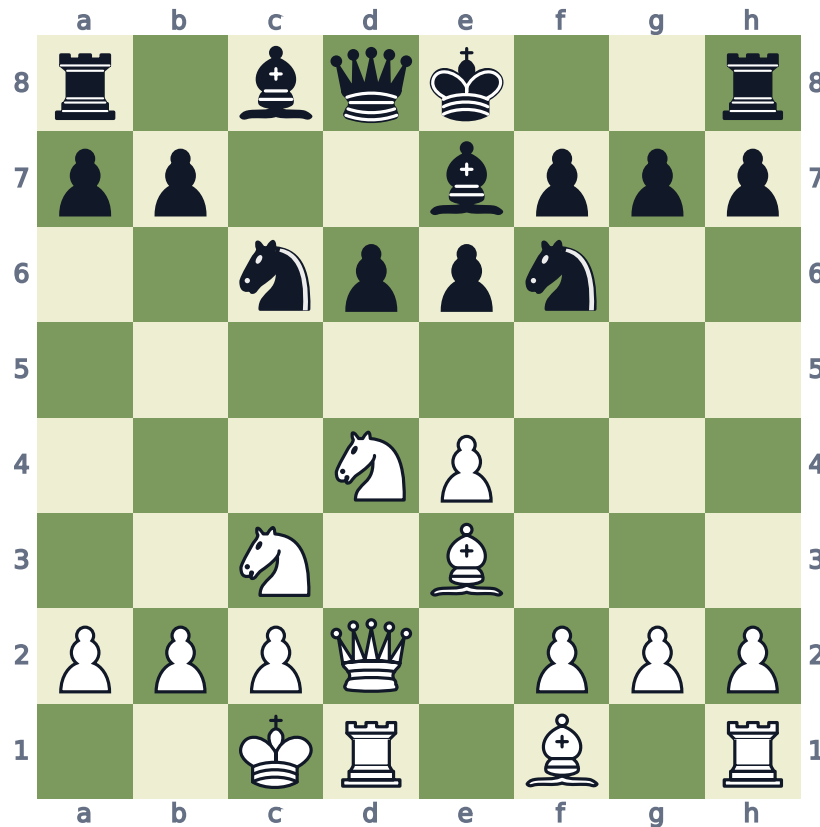
Opening identity: Black builds a sound center while keeping the light bishop outside the pawn chain.
 Common human mistake: Spending many tempi trapping the bishop while Black breaks open the center. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +1.44 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 12 OF 20

Open Sicilian: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Rb8. Punishment: 1. Ndb5 Ng4 2. Bf4 e5 3. Bg3 O-O 4. Kb1 Be6 5. Nxd6. Safer engine line: 1. Ng4 Bc4 2. Nxe3 Qxe3 3. Bd7.

WHY IT WORKS

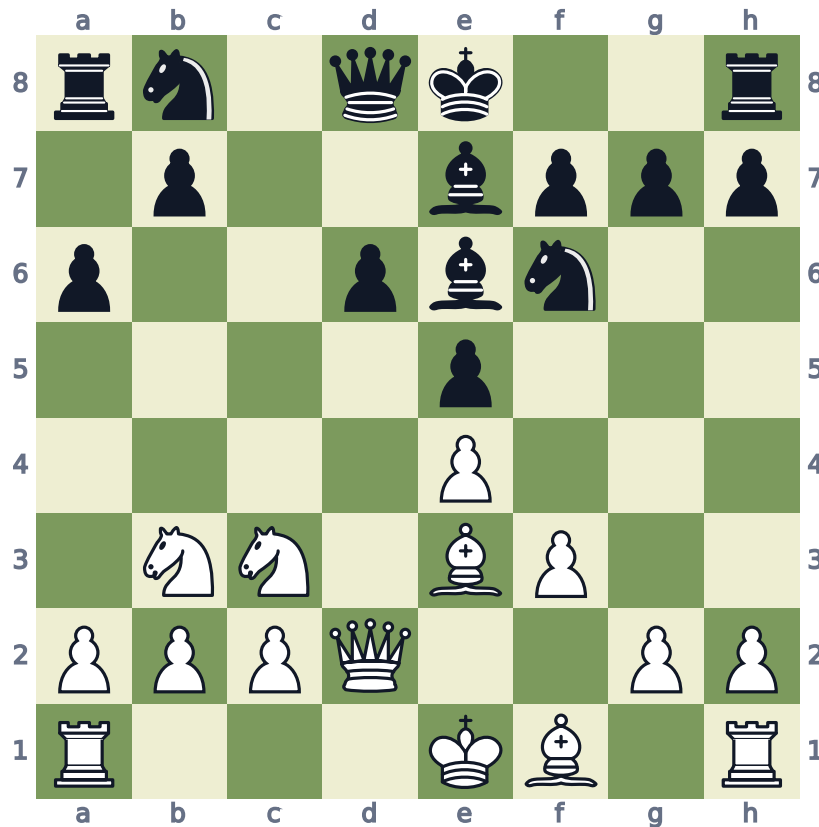
Opening identity: An asymmetrical center gives White activity and Black a queenside majority. Common human mistake: Launching pawns while key defenders remain undeveloped. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +1.42 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 13 OF 20

Sicilian Najdorf: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: d5. Punishment: 1. exd5 Nxd5 2. Nxd5 Qxd5 3. Qxd5 Bxd5 4. O-O-O Be6 5. Bd3 Nd7. Safer engine line: 1. h5 Be2 2. Nbd7 Nd5 3. Bxd5.

WHY IT WORKS

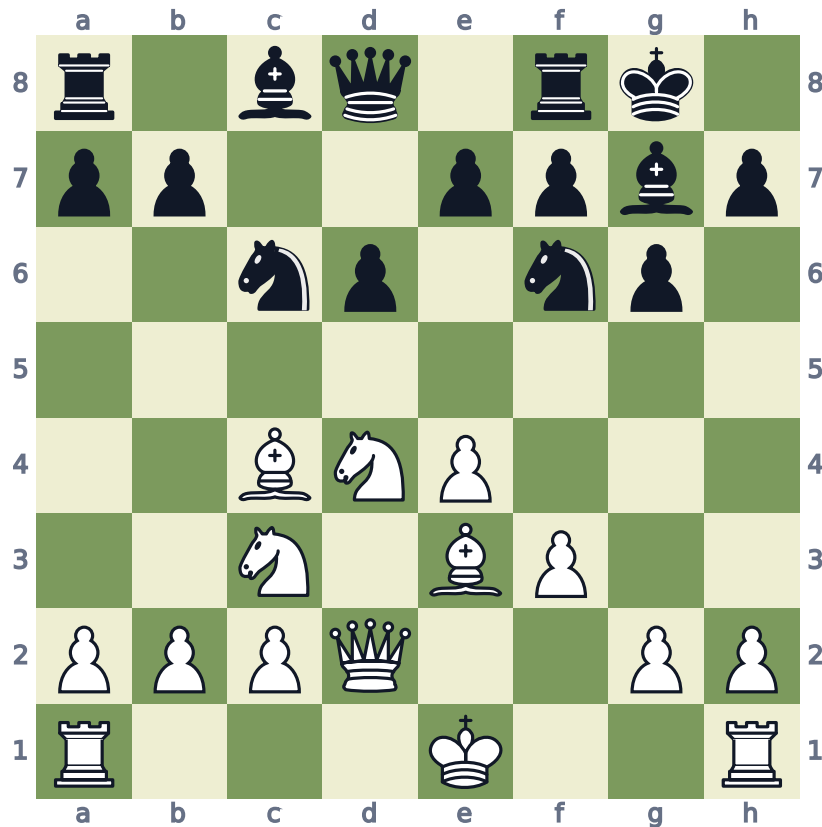
Opening identity: Black's ...a6 controls b5 and prepares flexible queenside expansion. Common human mistake: Memorizing sharp moves without understanding why ...a6 changes b5. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.82 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 14 OF 20

Sicilian Dragon: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: a6. Punishment: 1. h4 Nxd4 2. Bxd4 b5 3. Bb3 a5 4. h5 e5 5. Be3 Nxh5. Safer engine line: 1. Bd7 O-O-O 2. Nxd4 Bxd4 3. Rc8 Bb3 4. b5.

WHY IT WORKS

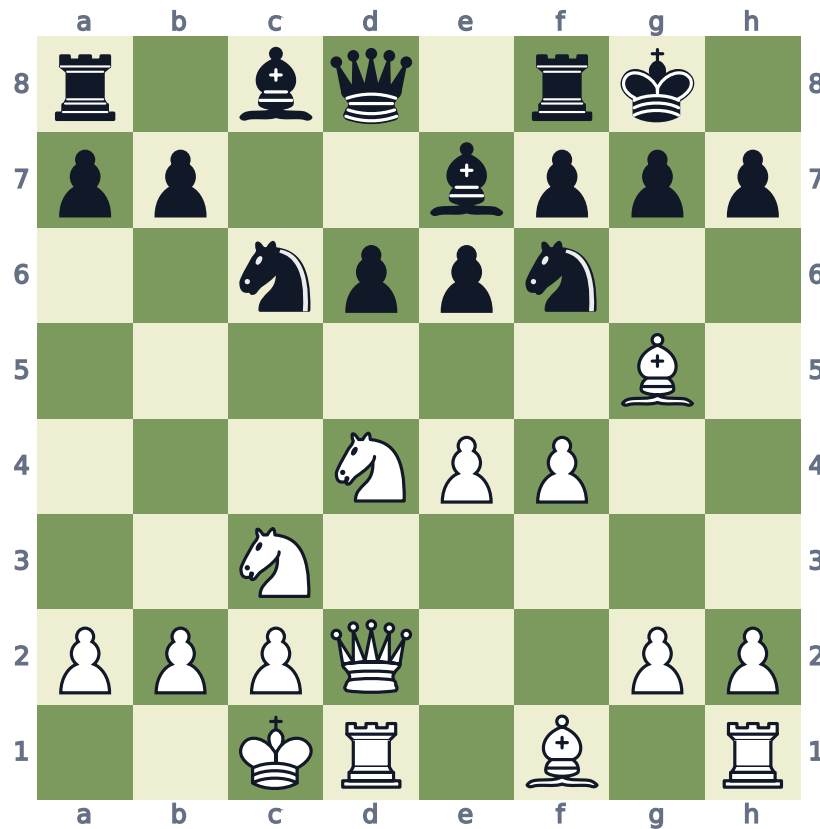
Opening identity: Black's fianchetto bishop attacks the center while both sides race on opposite wings. Common human mistake: Starting the pawn race before the queen, bishops, and king are coordinated. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +1.05 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 15 OF 20

Classical Sicilian: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: a6. Punishment: 1. Nxc6 bxc6 2. e5 dxe5 3. fxe5 Nd5 4. Ne4 Qc7 5. Bxe7 Nxe7.
 Safer engine line: 1. h6 Bh4 2. e5 Nf5 3. Bxf5 exf5 4. d5 fxe5 5. Nxe5.

WHY IT WORKS

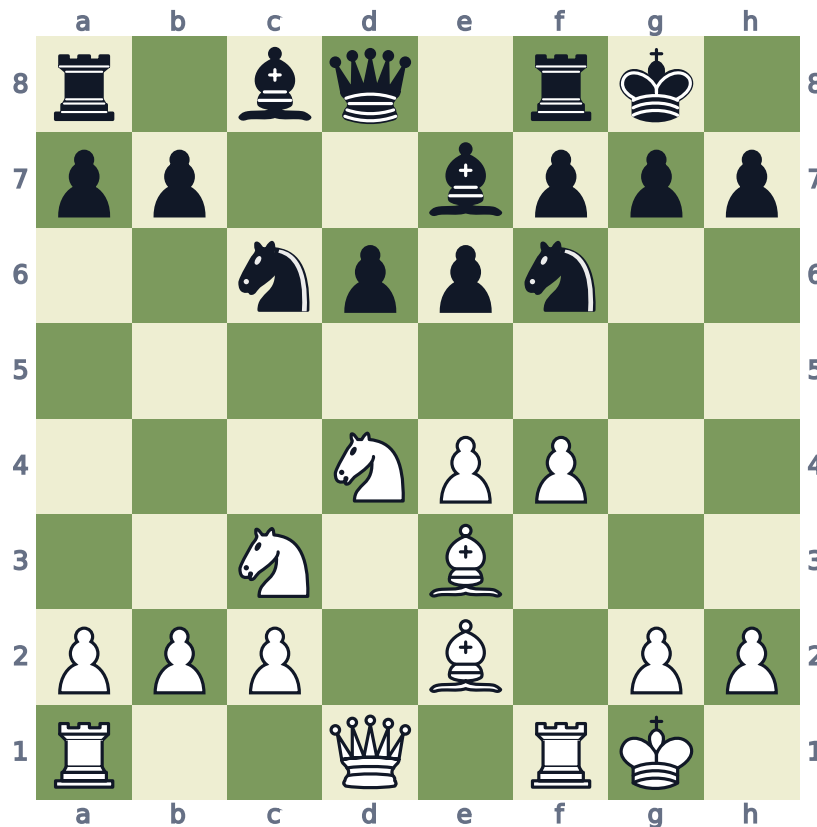
Opening identity: Black develops both knights naturally and keeps several central structures available.
 Common human mistake: Treating every pin as permission to attack without checking ...Nxd4 tactics. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +1.04 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 16 OF 20

Sicilian Scheveningen: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Re8. Punishment: 1. Kh1 e5 2. fxe5 dxe5 3. Nxc6 bxc6 4. Qe1 Be6. Safer engine line: 1. e5 fxe5 2. dxe5 Nxc6 3. bxc6 Qxd8 4. Rxd8.

WHY IT WORKS

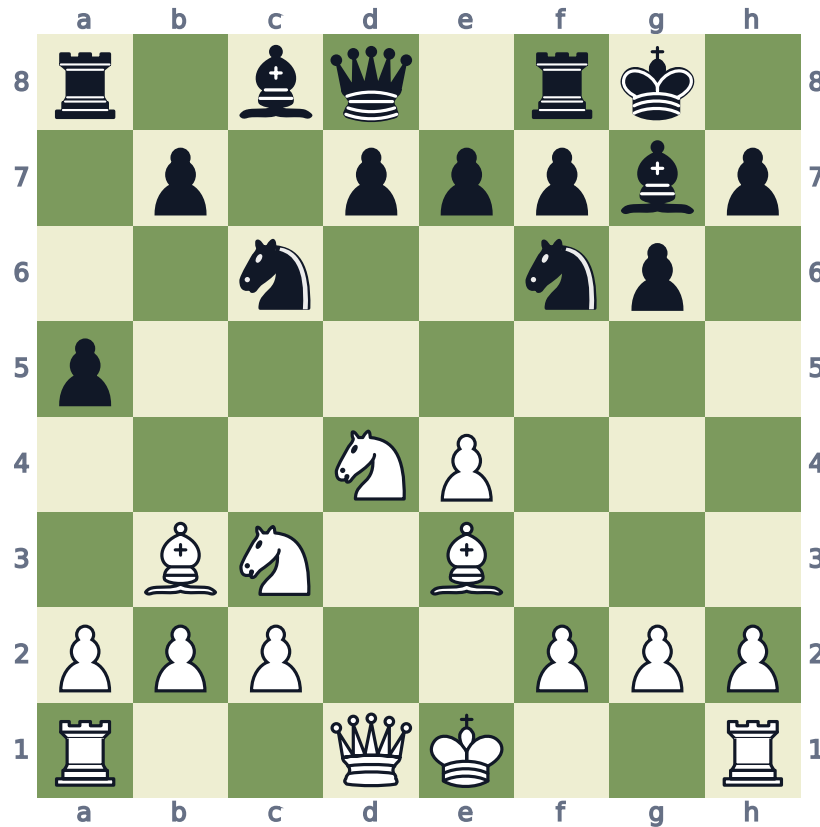
Opening identity: Black's compact e6-d6 center controls key squares and invites a dynamic attack-counterattack battle. Common human mistake: Pushing f5 before enough pieces can exploit the opened lines. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.57 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 17 OF 20

Accelerated Dragon: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Qf3. Punishment: 1. Ne5 Qe2 2. a4 Bxa4 3. Nxe4 Nxe4 4. Rxa4 Nc3 5. Ra6 f4. Safer engine line: 1. O-O Ng4 2. Qxg4 Nxd4 3. Rad1 d6.

WHY IT WORKS

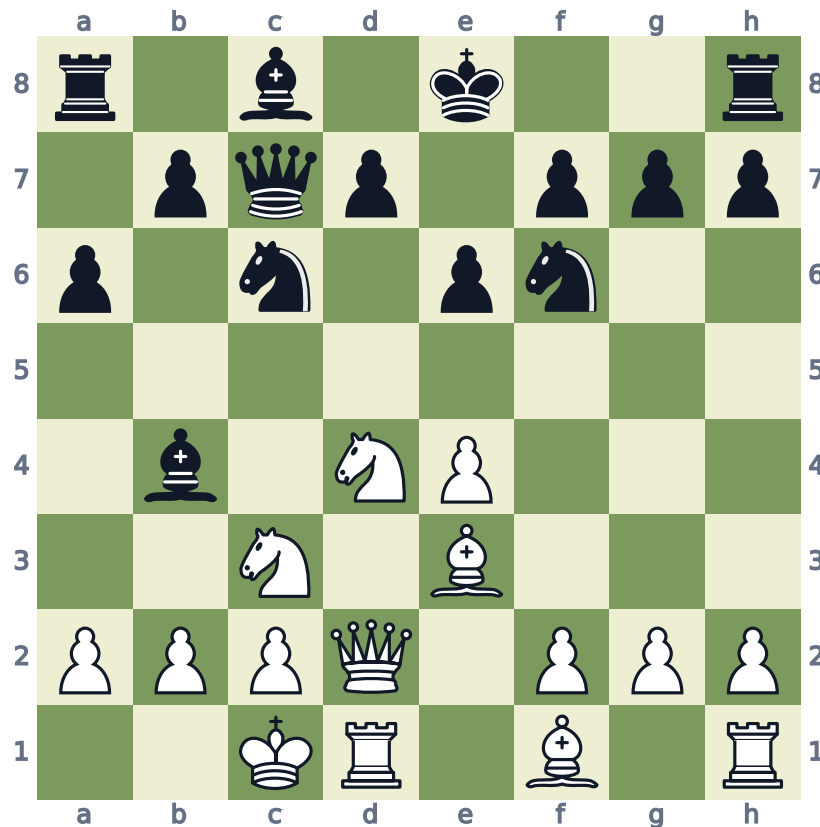
Opening identity: Black fianchettoes without ...d6, keeping the option of a one-move ...d5 break. Common human mistake: Playing as if this were a regular Dragon and allowing ...d5 in one move. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.82 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 18 OF 20

Sicilian Taimanov: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Be2. Punishment: 1. Nxe4 Nxc6 2. Qxc6 Bf3 3. Nxd2 Bxc6 4. Nc4 Rd4 5. Nxe3 Rxb4.
 Safer engine line: 1. f3 b5 2. a3 Be7 3. g4 O-O 4. h4 Rb8.

WHY IT WORKS

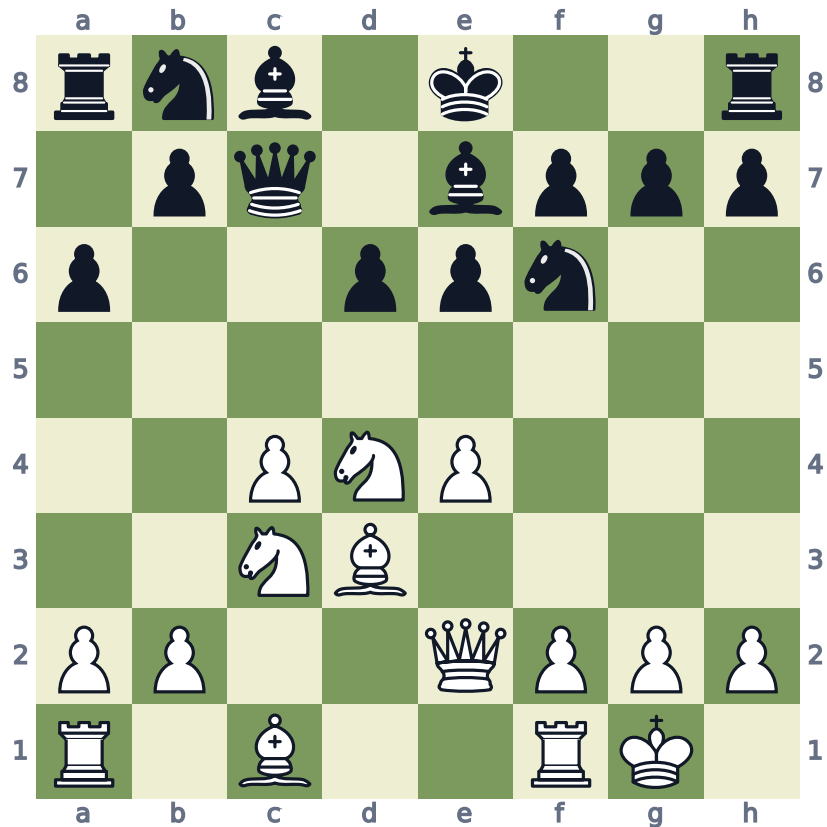
Opening identity: A flexible ...e6 and ...Nc6 setup uses the queen on c7 to support active piece play.
 Common human mistake: Castling long automatically into a prepared queenside expansion. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +1.49 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 19 OF 20

Sicilian Kan: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: h6. Punishment: 1. f4 Nfd7 2. Be3 Nc6 3. Kh1 O-O 4. Nxc6 bxc6 5. Rf3 e5. Safer engine line: 1. Nc6 Nxc6 2. bxc6 f4 3. Nd7 Kh1 4. Bb7.

WHY IT WORKS

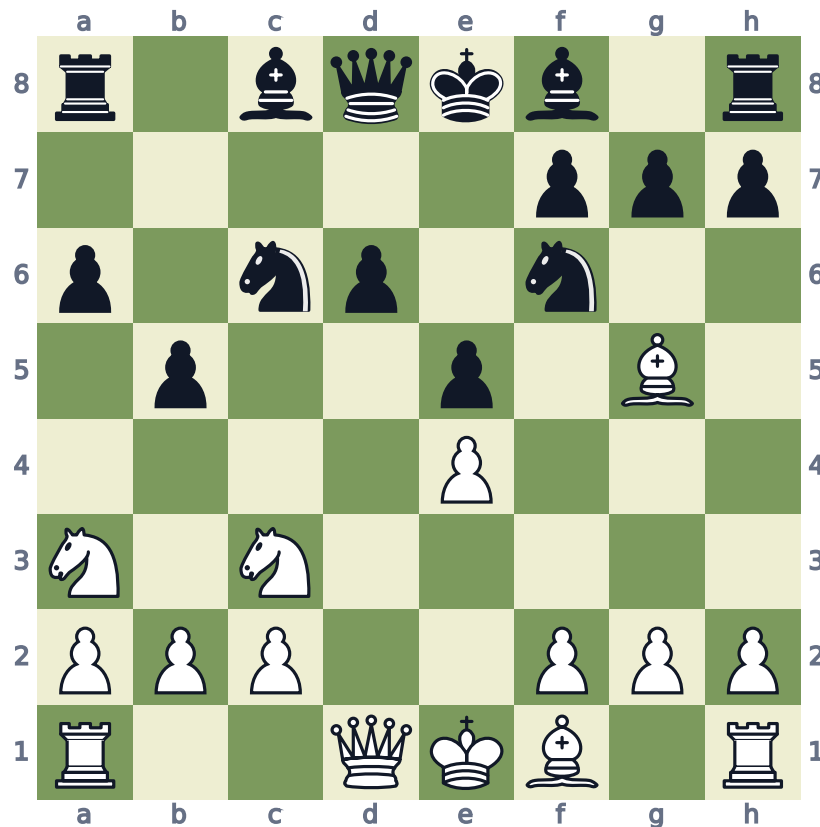
Opening identity: Black delays knight development to keep the queenside structure highly flexible. Common human mistake: Expanding with c4 and f4 before making the king safe. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +1.02 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 20 OF 20

Sicilian Sveshnikov: refuse the tempting move



VERIFIED LINE

Temptation: Ncb1. Punishment: 1. d5 exd5 2. Bc5 Qd2 3. Nd4 c3 4. Nf5 Nc2 5. O-O g3. Safer engine line: 1. Bxf6 Qxf6 2. Nd5 Qd8 3. c4 b4 4. Nc2 a5 5. a3 b3.

WHY IT WORKS

Opening identity: Black accepts a backward d-pawn and weak d5-square in return for time and activity. Common human mistake: Judging the position only by weak squares and ignoring Black's concrete activity. The point is to refute the move by development, king safety, loose-piece geometry, or move order - not to memorize a trick.

SCORING

2 punishment, 2 safe line, 2 explanation of the violated principle = 6 points Engine assessment: +1.19 from the side-to-move perspective.

REVIEW

Final mixed review

1

Select five missed positions and solve them in random order without motif names.

2

Explain why the best defense fails in each of those positions.

3

Reverse the board and describe whether the same geometry is still easy to recognize.

4

Find one example of the theme in your own game or a Fritz training game.

5

Retest under a shorter clock only after calculation is accurate without time pressure.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Repeat missed positions tomorrow, then after 3, 7, 14, and 30 days. Remove a position only after two correct solutions with a complete explanation.